38 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Transport, Housing & Cities

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

Cụm từ | Từ đồng nghĩa | Từ nối | Khung câu | Câu mang ý | Câu ví dụ

Extent

#6 Extent · 279 từ · AI 8.0

Some argue that housing is the main reason for social problems. To what extent do you agree?

Crowded flats, damp rooms and families with no home at all are visible in many cities, and some argue that housing is the main reason for social problems. I agree only to a limited extent, since housing is an important factor, but low income, unemployment and weak education also play major roles.

To begin with, poor housing contributes to many social problems. Overcrowded, unsafe or unaffordable homes damage health, schooling and family stability. A child who shares one room with five relatives, for example, has no quiet place to study and may fall behind at school. Damp and badly heated flats cause illnesses, and tension within crowded families can lead to conflict or violence. Neighbourhoods with large numbers of run-down buildings often suffer from crime and social neglect, because residents have little stake in the area. People who cannot afford rent may spend most of their income on housing and have little left for food, education or leisure.

However, housing is not the only cause. Low income, unemployment and weak education also drive crime and poverty. A person who has a secure home but no job, for example, may still turn to crime or suffer from depression. Many wealthy suburbs have social problems such as drug abuse, whereas some poor communities with strong family and community ties remain peaceful. Housing policy is therefore necessary but insufficient. Governments that want to reduce social problems should combine decent, affordable homes with job creation, good schools and support for families, since each factor reinforces the others.

In conclusion, housing is one major factor among several, so I agree only to a limited extent that it is the main reason for social problems.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Crowded flats, damp rooms** — căn hộ chật, phòng ẩm
- **housing is the main reason for social problems** — nhà ở là nguyên nhân chính của các vấn đề xã hội
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **Low income, unemployment and weak education** — thu nhập thấp, thất nghiệp và giáo dục yếu
- **Overcrowded, unsafe or unaffordable homes** — những ngôi nhà quá đông, không an toàn hoặc không đủ khả năng chi trả
- **damage health, schooling and family stability** — gây hại sức khoẻ, việc học và sự ổn định gia đình
- **shares one room with five relatives** — chung một phòng với năm người thân
- **no quiet place to study** — không có chỗ yên tĩnh để học
- **fall behind at school** — tụt lại ở trường
- **Damp and badly heated flats** — căn hộ ẩm và sưởi kém
- **run-down buildings** — các toà nhà xuống cấp
- **social neglect** — sự bỏ mặc xã hội
- **spend most of their income on housing** — chi phần lớn thu nhập cho nhà ở
- **drive crime and poverty** — thúc đẩy tội phạm và nghèo đói
- **a secure home but no job** — có nhà ổn định nhưng không có việc
- **drug abuse** — lạm dụng ma tuý
- **strong family and community ties** — mối liên kết gia đình và cộng đồng mạnh
- **necessary but insufficient** — cần thiết nhưng chưa đủ
- **decent, affordable homes** — nhà ở tử tế, giá phải chăng
- **job creation** — tạo việc làm
- **one major factor among several** — một yếu tố lớn trong nhiều yếu tố
- **the main reason for social problems** — nguyên nhân chính của các vấn đề xã hội

#153 Extent · 280 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think driverless cars will become common in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Test vehicles with no human at the wheel already drive on the streets of a few cities, and the question is how common driverless cars will become within twenty years. I believe that they will become common in some places, but not everywhere.

To begin with, driverless cars have strong advantages that will push their spread. They can reduce human error and help non-drivers. Since most accidents are caused by tired, distracted or drunk drivers, a computer that never loses attention could save many lives. An elderly man who can no longer drive, for example, would gain independence from a car that takes him to the doctor or to see friends. Companies are investing billions, and early services, known as robotaxis, already operate in limited areas. Cheaper sensors and better artificial intelligence will make the systems more reliable, and fleets of shared driverless vehicles could cut the cost of travel and reduce the need for parking space.

However, complex traffic, legal questions, high costs and public trust slow adoption. Machines still struggle with unusual events such as road works, heavy snow or the unpredictable behaviour of cyclists, and they remain vulnerable to hacking. Who is responsible for an accident that involves a driverless car is still unclear, and many people are afraid to give up control. Professional drivers also fear for their jobs, which may cause political resistance. Robotaxis and motorway freight will therefore probably become established first, in well-mapped cities with good weather, while private ownership of fully automatic cars remains rare in rural and older urban areas.

In conclusion, driverless cars will become common in selected places within twenty years, but they will not replace human drivers everywhere.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **no human at the wheel** — không có người cầm lái
- **driverless cars** — xe không người lái
- **reduce human error and help non-drivers** — giảm lỗi của con người và giúp người không lái xe
- **tired, distracted or drunk drivers** — tài xế mệt mỏi, mất tập trung hoặc say rượu
- **never loses attention** — không bao giờ mất tập trung
- **can no longer drive** — không còn lái xe được nữa
- **gain independence** — có được sự độc lập
- **robotaxis** — taxi robot
- **Cheaper sensors and better artificial intelligence** — cảm biến rẻ hơn và trí tuệ nhân tạo tốt hơn
- **fleets of shared driverless vehicles** — đội xe không người lái dùng chung
- **parking space** — chỗ đỗ xe
- **complex traffic, legal questions, high costs and public trust** — giao thông phức tạp, vấn đề pháp lý, chi phí cao và niềm tin của công chúng
- **road works, heavy snow** — công trường đường, tuyết dày
- **unpredictable behaviour of cyclists** — hành vi khó lường của người đi xe đạp
- **vulnerable to hacking** — dễ bị tấn công mạng
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **give up control** — từ bỏ quyền kiểm soát
- **Professional drivers** — tài xế chuyên nghiệp
- **motorway freight** — vận tải hàng hoá đường cao tốc
- **well-mapped cities** — thành phố được lập bản đồ kỹ

#297 Extent · 286 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that private ownership is the main reason for social problems. To what extent do you agree?

Debates about wealth and fairness often focus on who owns land, factories and homes, and some argue that private ownership is the main reason for social problems. I agree only to a limited extent, since private ownership can widen inequality, but it is not the main cause of most social problems.

To begin with, private ownership can contribute to social problems. Concentrated ownership leaves some people without property or influence. A landlord who owns hundreds of flats, for example, can raise rents until tenants must leave, while a company owner may pay low wages to protect profit. Where a few families own most of the land or businesses, wealth passes from one generation to the next, and poor people find it hard to improve their position. Inequality in turn can lead to resentment, poor health and weaker trust within society. Owners may also neglect their social duties, for example by polluting rivers or ignoring safety rules to save money.

However, private ownership also rewards effort and innovation, and problems such as crime or poverty arise mostly from poor education and a lack of opportunity. Countries in which citizens can own property and start businesses generally enjoy more growth and more jobs than those in which the state controls everything. Many social problems exist under every system, including those with little private property, because they depend on family background, schooling, employment and government policy. Fair taxes, strong labour and tenant protection, competition laws and support for those in need can reduce the harm caused by unequal ownership. Reform is therefore more sensible than abolition.

In conclusion, private ownership is one factor in social problems, but not the main one, so I agree only to a limited extent.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **who owns land, factories and homes** — ai sở hữu đất, nhà máy và nhà ở
- **private ownership is the main reason for social problems** — sở hữu tư nhân là nguyên nhân chính của vấn đề xã hội
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **widen inequality** — làm bất bình đẳng sâu thêm
- **Concentrated ownership** — sự sở hữu tập trung
- **without property or influence** — không có tài sản hay ảnh hưởng
- **owns hundreds of flats** — sở hữu hàng trăm căn hộ
- **raise rents until tenants must leave** — tăng tiền thuê đến khi người thuê phải rời đi
- **pay low wages to protect profit** — trả lương thấp để bảo vệ lợi nhuận
- **wealth passes from one generation to the next** — của cải truyền từ thế hệ này sang thế hệ khác
- **improve their position** — cải thiện vị thế của họ
- **resentment, poor health and weaker trust** — sự oán giận, sức khoẻ kém và niềm tin yếu đi
- **social duties** — trách nhiệm xã hội
- **polluting rivers** — làm ô nhiễm sông ngòi
- **rewards effort and innovation** — thưởng cho nỗ lực và đổi mới
- **poor education and a lack of opportunity** — giáo dục kém và thiếu cơ hội
- **start businesses** — khởi nghiệp
- **family background, schooling, employment and government policy** — hoàn cảnh gia đình, giáo dục, việc làm và chính sách chính phủ
- **Fair taxes, strong labour and tenant protection** — thuế công bằng, bảo vệ mạnh người lao động và người thuê nhà
- **competition laws** — luật cạnh tranh

#352 Extent · 270 từ · AI 7.0

Some argue that stricter zoning laws improve city livability. To what extent do you agree?

Planning rules decide where homes, shops and factories may be built, and some argue that stricter zoning laws improve city livability. I agree to a limited extent, since strict zoning protects residential quality but can raise housing costs.

To begin with, zoning can make cities more pleasant. Separating factories from homes, protecting parks and limiting building height make neighbourhoods pleasant. A family whose street is separated from a noisy industrial area, for example, enjoys cleaner air and quieter nights. Zoning also keeps green space from being built over, secures room for schools and clinics, and ensures that new buildings fit with the character of an area. In historic centres, strict rules protect heritage and attract tourism. Without such laws, developers might build tall blocks beside small houses or put polluting factories next to schools, and the public would pay the price in health and quality of life.

However, tight limits restrict new homes and push prices up. Rules that allow only detached houses in large areas, or that set high minimum sizes for plots, prevent the construction of flats and make housing unaffordable for young people and workers. Strict separation of uses also forces residents to travel by car to shops and offices, which increases traffic and pollution. Some cities therefore allow mixed-use development, in which homes, shops and small businesses stand together, and permit taller buildings near stations. Flexible, well-designed zoning works best: it should protect the environment and safety while leaving room for growth and diversity.

In conclusion, stricter zoning laws improve livability to a limited extent, so planners should seek balance and not simply impose more restrictions.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Planning rules decide where homes, shops and factories may be built** — quy tắc quy hoạch quyết định nơi nhà ở, cửa hàng và nhà máy được xây
- **stricter zoning laws** — luật phân vùng nghiêm ngặt hơn
- **improve city livability** — cải thiện khả năng sống của thành phố
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **raise housing costs** — làm tăng chi phí nhà ở
- **Separating factories from homes** — tách nhà máy khỏi khu nhà ở
- **protecting parks and limiting building height** — bảo vệ công viên và giới hạn chiều cao toà nhà
- **a noisy industrial area** — khu công nghiệp ồn ào
- **cleaner air and quieter nights** — không khí sạch hơn và đêm yên tĩnh hơn
- **green space** — không gian xanh
- **built over** — bị xây lên
- **room for schools and clinics** — chỗ cho trường học và trạm y tế
- **the character of an area** — đặc trưng của một khu vực
- **protect heritage and attract tourism** — bảo vệ di sản và thu hút du lịch
- **polluting factories next to schools** — nhà máy gây ô nhiễm cạnh trường học
- **quality of life** — chất lượng cuộc sống
- **tight limits restrict new homes and push prices up** — hạn chế chặt chẽ làm hạn chế nhà mới và đẩy giá lên
- **detached houses in large areas** — nhà riêng biệt ở các khu rộng lớn
- **minimum sizes for plots** — kích thước tối thiểu của lô đất
- **unaffordable for young people and workers** — vượt quá khả năng chi trả của người trẻ và người lao động
- **mixed-use development** — phát triển đa chức năng
- **taller buildings near stations** — toà nhà cao hơn gần nhà ga
- **Flexible, well-designed zoning** — phân vùng linh hoạt và thiết kế tốt

#375 Extent · 284 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think smart cities will improve quality of life in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Sensors, cameras and apps are already used to manage traffic, lighting and rubbish in a growing number of cities, and the question is how far smart cities will improve quality of life within twenty years. I believe that they will improve it considerably, although privacy and cost limit the gain.

To begin with, smart cities will improve efficiency and convenience. Sensors manage traffic, lighting and waste and online services save time. A traffic system that adjusts signals according to real-time flows, for example, can shorten journeys, cut fuel use and reduce air pollution. Smart meters help households to save electricity and water, and apps show when the next bus will arrive or where a parking space is free. Digital services allow citizens to pay taxes, report faults and obtain permits without queuing, and sensors can warn of floods or gas leaks and send help quickly. Elderly residents may also benefit from monitoring systems that detect falls.

However, constant data collection and high costs worry citizens and may leave poorer districts behind. Cameras and sensors that track movements raise concerns about privacy, and databases can be hacked or misused by companies and authorities. Installing and maintaining the technology is expensive, so wealthy districts may be improved first while others lack even basic services. Residents without smartphones or digital skills may be excluded from services which are available only online. Quality of life will therefore improve most where technology serves residents, with strong rules on data protection, open decision-making and attention to everyone's needs, and not where it is introduced for its own sake.

In conclusion, smart cities will considerably improve efficiency and convenience over the next twenty years, but they must protect privacy and fairness.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Sensors, cameras and apps** — cảm biến, camera và ứng dụng
- **manage traffic, lighting and rubbish** — quản lý giao thông, chiếu sáng và rác
- **smart cities** — thành phố thông minh
- **improve quality of life** — cải thiện chất lượng cuộc sống
- **efficiency and convenience** — hiệu quả và sự tiện lợi
- **save time** — tiết kiệm thời gian
- **adjusts signals according to real-time flows** — điều chỉnh tín hiệu theo luồng giao thông thời gian thực
- **shorten journeys, cut fuel use** — rút ngắn hành trình, giảm tiêu thụ nhiên liệu
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **smart meters** — công tơ thông minh
- **when the next bus will arrive** — khi nào xe buýt kế tiếp đến
- **a parking space is free** — có chỗ đỗ xe trống
- **pay taxes, report faults and obtain permits** — nộp thuế, báo lỗi và xin giấy phép
- **warn of floods or gas leaks** — cảnh báo lũ lụt hoặc rò rỉ khí gas
- **monitoring systems that detect falls** — hệ thống giám sát phát hiện té ngã
- **constant data collection and high costs** — thu thập dữ liệu liên tục và chi phí cao
- **track movements** — theo dõi sự di chuyển
- **hacked or misused** — bị tấn công hoặc lạm dụng
- **wealthy districts may be improved first** — các khu giàu có thể được cải thiện trước
- **without smartphones or digital skills** — không có điện thoại thông minh hay kỹ năng số
- **available only online** — chỉ có trực tuyến
- **quality of life** — chất lượng cuộc sống
- **data protection** — bảo vệ dữ liệu
- **decision-making** — ra quyết định
- **for its own sake** — vì chính nó

Agree / Disagree

#14 Agree / Disagree · 282 từ · AI 7.5

Many people think that public transport has improved people's lives. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Millions of people board buses, trains and trams every morning, and many think that public transport has improved people's lives. I agree with this view, since it gives affordable access to work, education and services, although it is not perfect.

To begin with, public transport improves lives by giving affordable access to opportunity. People without cars can reach jobs and hospitals cheaply, and students can attend distant schools. A cleaner who lives on the edge of a city, for example, can reach an office in the centre by metro for the price of a coffee, instead of buying and maintaining a car. Public transport also helps older people and those with disabilities to remain independent, and it connects villages with towns and markets. In countries where it is reliable, families spend much less of their income on travel.

Furthermore, public transport benefits whole cities. Cities have less congestion and pollution when many people share vehicles, and fewer cars on the road mean fewer accidents. Passengers can also read, work or rest during their journeys instead of concentrating on traffic, which reduces stress. However, service can be crowded, slow or missing in remote areas, and poorly maintained systems can discourage use. Improvements such as frequent services, clean vehicles, safe stations and integrated tickets make the difference. Public transport also creates many jobs in driving, maintenance and engineering, and it supports local shops near stations. Investment in public transport is therefore an investment in opportunity, public health and the environment. Cities that neglect it often find that their roads, air and budgets all suffer.

In conclusion, I agree that public transport has improved people's lives, and governments should continue to expand and modernise it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **board buses, trains and trams** — lên xe buýt, tàu hoả và xe điện
- **public transport has improved people's lives** — giao thông công cộng đã cải thiện đời sống con người
- **affordable access to work, education and services** — khả năng tiếp cận việc làm, giáo dục và dịch vụ với giá phải chăng
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **People without cars** — những người không có xe hơi
- **reach jobs and hospitals cheaply** — đến nơi làm việc và bệnh viện với chi phí rẻ
- **attend distant schools** — đi học ở trường xa
- **the edge of a city** — vùng rìa thành phố
- **for the price of a coffee** — với giá một ly cà phê
- **buying and maintaining a car** — mua và bảo dưỡng xe hơi
- **remain independent** — duy trì sự độc lập
- **connects villages with towns and markets** — kết nối làng với thị trấn và chợ
- **spend much less of their income on travel** — chi ít thu nhập hơn cho việc đi lại
- **less congestion and pollution** — ít tắc nghẽn và ô nhiễm hơn
- **fewer cars** — ít xe hơn
- **fewer accidents** — ít tai nạn hơn
- **read, work or rest during their journeys** — đọc, làm việc hoặc nghỉ ngơi trong chuyến đi
- **crowded, slow or missing** — đông đúc, chậm hoặc không có
- **remote areas** — vùng xa xôi
- **poorly maintained** — bảo trì kém
- **integrated tickets** — vé tích hợp
- **an investment in opportunity, public health and the environment** — khoản đầu tư vào cơ hội, sức khoẻ cộng đồng và môi trường

#15 Agree / Disagree · 266 từ · AI 7.0

Some believe public housing should be regulated by law. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Rents and house prices have risen sharply in many cities, and some believe that public housing should be regulated by law. I agree to a large extent, since regulation ensures quality and fair allocation, although it must be balanced.

To begin with, public housing should be regulated by law to ensure quality and fair allocation. Clear rules on standards, rents and eligibility protect tenants and prevent favouritism. A family that waits for years on a list, for example, would be treated unfairly if officials could give flats to friends or to people who pay bribes. Laws can require safe construction, adequate space, heating and repairs, so that residents do not live in unhealthy buildings. They can also set rents according to income and give priority to the poorest families, the elderly and people with disabilities. Since public money is used, citizens have the right to know that it is spent properly.

However, excessive regulation can raise costs and discourage building. If every project must pass long approval procedures, or if rent controls are too strict, builders and local authorities may stop constructing new homes, which makes shortages worse. Rules that fix tenants in the same flat for life, regardless of changing income, may also prevent those in greater need from obtaining a home. Balanced legislation, with clear standards but flexible procedures and regular review, keeps public housing effective. Independent bodies should inspect quality and publish information about waiting lists and allocations.

In conclusion, I agree that public housing should be regulated by law, but regulation should be proportionate so that it protects residents without restricting supply.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Rents and house prices have risen sharply** — giá thuê và giá nhà tăng mạnh
- **public housing should be regulated by law** — nhà ở công nên được điều tiết bằng luật
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **quality and fair allocation** — chất lượng và phân bổ công bằng
- **Clear rules on standards, rents and eligibility** — quy tắc rõ ràng về tiêu chuẩn, giá thuê và điều kiện đủ tư cách
- **protect tenants and prevent favouritism** — bảo vệ người thuê và ngăn thiên vị
- **waits for years on a list** — chờ nhiều năm trong danh sách
- **pay bribes** — đưa hối lộ
- **safe construction, adequate space, heating and repairs** — xây dựng an toàn, đủ không gian, sưởi ấm và sửa chữa
- **unhealthy buildings** — toà nhà không lành mạnh
- **set rents according to income** — đặt giá thuê theo thu nhập
- **priority to the poorest families, the elderly and people with disabilities** — ưu tiên cho gia đình nghèo nhất, người già và người khuyết tật
- **public money is used** — tiền công được sử dụng
- **Excessive regulation can raise costs** — quy định quá mức có thể làm tăng chi phí
- **long approval procedures** — thủ tục phê duyệt kéo dài
- **rent controls** — kiểm soát giá thuê
- **new homes** — nhà mới
- **shortages worse** — thiếu hụt tệ hơn
- **Balanced legislation** — luật pháp cân bằng
- **public housing** — nhà ở công
- **Independent bodies should inspect quality** — cơ quan độc lập nên kiểm tra chất lượng
- **waiting lists** — danh sách chờ
- **proportionate** — tương xứng

#61 Agree / Disagree · 278 từ · AI 7.0

Some people say that driver’s licenses should be harder to obtain. Do you agree or disagree?

Every year, thousands of people die on the roads, and some say that driver's licences should be harder to obtain. I agree to a large extent, since a more demanding test would make roads safer if it concentrates on real skills.

To begin with, a harder driving test would make roads safer. Longer practice, hazard training and stricter tests reduce reckless young drivers. A learner who must complete fifty hours of supervised driving, including at night and in the rain, for example, will have far more experience when she drives alone for the first time. Many accidents are caused by inexperience and by drivers who misjudge speed and distance, so better preparation could save lives. Some countries use graduated licences, which limit passengers or night driving for new drivers, and they have recorded fewer crashes among young people. Regular retesting of older drivers could also help to identify those whose eyesight or reactions have declined.

However, a harder test has drawbacks. Higher costs and difficulty can exclude people who need cars for work, particularly in rural areas where there is no public transport. If the test is difficult but unrelated to the real dangers of the road, it will not improve behaviour, and some people may simply drive without a licence. The quality of training therefore matters more than difficulty alone. Governments should focus on practical skills, such as hazard perception and driving in bad weather, while keeping fees reasonable and offering support for those on low incomes. Strong enforcement against drink driving and speeding is equally important.

In conclusion, I agree that licences should be harder to obtain, provided that the test is practical, fair and affordable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **thousands of people die on the roads** — hàng nghìn người chết trên đường
- **driver's licences should be harder to obtain** — bằng lái xe nên khó lấy hơn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **Longer practice, hazard training and stricter tests** — luyện tập lâu hơn, huấn luyện nhận biết nguy hiểm và kỳ thi nghiêm ngặt hơn
- **reckless young drivers** — tài xế trẻ liều lĩnh
- **fifty hours of supervised driving** — năm mươi giờ lái xe có giám sát
- **at night and in the rain** — vào ban đêm và dưới mưa
- **drives alone for the first time** — lái xe một mình lần đầu
- **inexperience** — sự thiếu kinh nghiệm
- **misjudge speed and distance** — đánh giá sai tốc độ và khoảng cách
- **graduated licences** — bằng lái theo từng giai đoạn
- **fewer crashes among young people** — ít vụ va chạm hơn ở người trẻ
- **Regular retesting of older drivers** — kiểm tra lại định kỳ tài xế lớn tuổi
- **eyesight or reactions have declined** — thị lực hoặc phản xạ đã suy giảm
- **need cars for work** — cần xe hơi để làm việc
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **drive without a licence** — lái xe không có bằng
- **practical skills** — kỹ năng thực tế
- **hazard perception** — nhận biết nguy hiểm
- **driving in bad weather** — lái xe trong thời tiết xấu
- **on low incomes** — có thu nhập thấp
- **drink driving and speeding** — lái xe khi say rượu và chạy quá tốc độ
- **licences** — giấy phép
- **practical, fair and affordable** — thực tế, công bằng và giá phải chăng

#147 Agree / Disagree · 279 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that electric scooters are dangerous in cities. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Rental scooters now stand on almost every corner in many cities, and many people say that electric scooters are dangerous. I agree to a large extent, since riders and pedestrians suffer injuries when there are no rules, although scooters also offer clean short-distance travel.

To begin with, electric scooters are dangerous when used without rules. Riders travel fast on pavements and often without helmets, causing injuries to themselves and pedestrians. A rider who speeds along a crowded pavement at night, for example, may hit an elderly walker, and a fall at twenty-five kilometres an hour can cause serious head injuries. Hospitals in several cities have reported large increases in scooter-related casualties, many involving alcohol. Small wheels make scooters unstable on uneven roads, and drivers often fail to see riders, especially in the dark. Scooters left lying on pavements also become obstacles for blind people and wheelchair users.

However, scooters bring benefits that should not be ignored. They reduce car use for short trips, produce no exhaust fumes and are cheap, and they help people to reach stations and shops quickly. If speed limits, lanes and parking rules apply, much of the danger can be reduced. A city that requires helmets, limits speed to fifteen kilometres an hour in busy areas, bans riding on pavements and fines abandoned scooters, for example, can keep the benefits while lowering the risk. Operators can also use technology to slow scooters automatically in crowded zones and to prevent use by drunk riders. Regulation can therefore make them safer without removing them.

In conclusion, I agree that electric scooters are dangerous in cities, but their risks can be controlled through strict rules and better infrastructure.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Rental scooters now stand on almost every corner** — xe scooter cho thuê nay đứng ở hầu hết các góc phố
- **electric scooters are dangerous** — xe scooter điện nguy hiểm
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **travel fast on pavements and often without helmets** — chạy nhanh trên vỉa hè và thường không đội mũ bảo hiểm
- **speeds along a crowded pavement at night** — phóng nhanh trên vỉa hè đông đúc ban đêm
- **hit an elderly walker** — đâm vào người đi bộ lớn tuổi
- **serious head injuries** — chấn thương đầu nghiêm trọng
- **scooter-related casualties** — thương vong liên quan đến xe scooter
- **Small wheels make scooters unstable** — bánh nhỏ khiến xe scooter không ổn định
- **obstacles for blind people and wheelchair users** — chướng ngại cho người mù và người dùng xe lăn
- **reduce car use for short trips** — giảm việc dùng ô tô cho các chuyến ngắn
- **no exhaust fumes** — không có khói thải
- **speed limits, lanes and parking rules** — giới hạn tốc độ, làn đường và quy tắc đỗ xe
- **requires helmets** — yêu cầu đội mũ bảo hiểm
- **fifteen kilometres an hour in busy areas** — mười lăm km/giờ ở khu vực đông đúc
- **bans riding on pavements** — cấm đi trên vỉa hè
- **fines abandoned scooters** — phạt xe scooter bị bỏ
- **slow scooters automatically in crowded zones** — tự động làm chậm xe scooter ở khu đông người
- **prevent use by drunk riders** — ngăn người say rượu sử dụng
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát

#389 Agree / Disagree · 295 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that learning to drive improves independence. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

For many teenagers, passing the driving test is a milestone, and many people say that learning to drive improves independence. I agree with this view, particularly where public transport is poor, although other forms of transport can also provide freedom.

To begin with, learning to drive increases independence. A driver can reach work, shops and family without timetables, which matters in villages. A young woman who lives in the countryside, for example, can accept a job twenty kilometres away, visit friends in the evening and take her grandmother to the hospital without waiting for a bus that runs twice a day. Drivers can also travel at any hour, carry heavy luggage and make several stops in a single trip. For people who work shifts, who have small children or who have to visit several places in one day, a car is often the only practical option. Having a licence also widens job opportunities, because some employers require it.

However, cars are costly, and good public transport can also give freedom. Buying, insuring and fuelling a car takes a large part of a young person's income, and traffic jams and parking problems limit the convenience in big cities. Residents of cities with frequent trains, trams and cycle lanes, for example, can move around easily without owning a car, and they avoid the stress and the expense. Driving also contributes to pollution and accidents. The value of a licence therefore depends on where one lives. Everyone benefits from being able to drive in an emergency, but in a well-served city, independence may come equally from a transport pass and a bicycle.

In conclusion, I agree that learning to drive improves independence, especially outside large cities, although the importance of driving is smaller where public transport is excellent.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **passing the driving test is a milestone** — đỗ kỳ thi lái xe là một cột mốc
- **learning to drive improves independence** — học lái xe cải thiện sự độc lập
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **without timetables** — không cần lịch trình
- **lives in the countryside** — sống ở nông thôn
- **accept a job twenty kilometres away** — nhận việc cách hai mươi km
- **visit friends in the evening** — thăm bạn vào buổi tối
- **take her grandmother to the hospital** — đưa bà đến bệnh viện
- **a bus that runs twice a day** — chuyến xe buýt chạy hai lần một ngày
- **at any hour** — vào bất kỳ giờ nào
- **carry heavy luggage** — chở hành lý nặng
- **several stops in a single trip** — nhiều điểm dừng trong một chuyến đi
- **work shifts** — làm việc theo ca
- **the only practical option** — lựa chọn thực tế duy nhất
- **widens job opportunities** — mở rộng cơ hội việc làm
- **Buying, insuring and fuelling a car** — mua, bảo hiểm và đổ nhiên liệu cho xe
- **traffic jams and parking problems** — tắc đường và vấn đề đỗ xe
- **frequent trains, trams and cycle lanes** — tàu, xe điện thường xuyên và làn xe đạp
- **without owning a car** — mà không cần sở hữu xe hơi
- **a transport pass and a bicycle** — một thẻ giao thông và một chiếc xe đạp

#499 Agree / Disagree · 283 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent do you agree or disagree that housing affordability is a government responsibility?

In many big cities, a young worker may need to spend half of a salary on rent, and some people argue that housing affordability is a government responsibility. I agree to a large extent, since markets alone leave many people priced out, although private builders must also play a part.

To begin with, governments should take responsibility for housing affordability because shelter is a basic need. Land shortages and speculation drive prices beyond ordinary incomes, so public housing, rent support, planning reform and tax measures are needed alongside private builders. A nurse or a teacher who cannot afford to live in the city where she works, for example, cannot be replaced by the market, and the whole community suffers when essential workers must leave. Only governments can plan land use, release public land for building and require developers to include affordable flats in new projects. Without such action, housing may become a privilege of the wealthy and of those with inherited property, increasing inequality between generations.

However, governments cannot solve the problem alone. Private companies build most homes, and they respond to demand and profit, so policies should encourage them to build more instead of discouraging investment through excessive rules or very strict rent controls. Individuals also have responsibilities, such as saving for a deposit and choosing homes they can afford. Partnerships between the state, builders, charities and local communities generally work best. Stable housing supports health, education and the economy, so the government cannot ignore the issue, but the best results come when the public and private sectors work together.

In conclusion, I agree that housing affordability is largely a government responsibility, but it should be pursued through cooperation with private builders.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend half of a salary on rent** — chi một nửa tiền lương cho tiền thuê nhà
- **housing affordability is a government responsibility** — khả năng chi trả nhà ở là trách nhiệm của chính phủ
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **markets alone leave many people priced out** — chỉ riêng thị trường khiến nhiều người không đủ khả năng mua
- **Shelter is a basic need** — chỗ ở là nhu cầu cơ bản
- **Land shortages and speculation** — sự khan hiếm đất và đầu cơ
- **beyond ordinary incomes** — vượt quá thu nhập bình thường
- **public housing, rent support, planning reform and tax measures** — nhà ở công, hỗ trợ tiền thuê, cải cách quy hoạch và biện pháp thuế
- **cannot afford to live in the city where she works** — không đủ khả năng sống ở thành phố nơi cô làm việc
- **cannot be replaced** — không thể thay thế
- **essential workers** — những người lao động thiết yếu
- **plan land use, release public land for building** — quy hoạch sử dụng đất, giải phóng đất công để xây dựng
- **affordable flats in new projects** — căn hộ giá phải chăng trong các dự án mới
- **a privilege of the wealthy** — đặc quyền của người giàu
- **inherited property** — tài sản thừa kế
- **inequality between generations** — bất bình đẳng giữa các thế hệ
- **respond to demand and profit** — phản ứng với nhu cầu và lợi nhuận
- **discouraging** — gây nản lòng
- **excessive rules or very strict rent controls** — quy định quá mức hoặc kiểm soát giá thuê quá chặt
- **saving for a deposit** — tiết kiệm tiền đặt cọc
- **Partnerships between the state, builders, charities and local communities** — sự hợp tác giữa nhà nước, nhà thầu, tổ chức từ thiện và cộng đồng địa phương
- **the public and private sectors work together** — khu vực công và tư cùng làm việc

Opinion

#16 Opinion · 278 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how urbanisation affects young people compared with older generations.

More than half of the world's population now lives in cities, and this essay will discuss how urbanisation affects young people compared with older generations, focusing on opportunity and on isolation.

To begin with, urbanisation brings opportunity to the young. Young adults find jobs, universities and social life in cities. A graduate from a small town, for example, may move to the capital because it offers hundreds of employers, networks and cultural events that her home town cannot match. Cities also provide public transport, nightlife and diverse communities, which many young people enjoy. However, high rents force many to share flats or live far from work, and competition for jobs and housing creates pressure and debt. Insecure contracts and the cost of living mean that some young people struggle to become independent despite the opportunities around them.

For older generations, the effects are different. Older residents may lose community ties as neighbours move, struggle with crowds and traffic, and benefit mainly from hospitals and specialised services. A pensioner who lives alone on the fifteenth floor of a block, for example, may seldom meet anyone and find stairs and busy streets difficult. Those who move from the countryside to live near their children often feel isolated and miss familiar surroundings. At the same time, cities offer healthcare, shops within walking distance and cultural activities which are useful to older people. Urban planners should therefore provide affordable housing for the young and accessible services, green spaces and meeting places for the old.

In conclusion, urbanisation offers young people opportunity but also pressure, while for older people it brings services but also isolation, so cities must be planned for every age.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **More than half of the world's population now lives in cities** — hơn một nửa dân số thế giới hiện sống ở thành phố
- **urbanisation affects young people** — đô thị hoá ảnh hưởng đến người trẻ
- **older generations** — các thế hệ lớn tuổi hơn
- **brings opportunity to the young** — mang lại cơ hội cho người trẻ
- **jobs, universities and social life** — việc làm, đại học và đời sống xã hội
- **hundreds of employers, networks and cultural events** — hàng trăm nhà tuyển dụng, mạng lưới quan hệ và sự kiện văn hoá
- **public transport, nightlife and diverse communities** — giao thông công cộng, cuộc sống về đêm và cộng đồng đa dạng
- **high rents force many to share flats** — tiền thuê cao buộc nhiều người ở ghép
- **pressure and debt** — áp lực và nợ nần
- **Insecure contracts** — hợp đồng không ổn định
- **become independent** — trở nên độc lập
- **lose community ties** — mất mối liên kết cộng đồng
- **struggle with crowds and traffic** — chật vật với đám đông và giao thông
- **lives alone on the fifteenth floor** — sống một mình ở tầng mười lăm
- **feel isolated** — cảm thấy cô lập
- **at the same time** — đồng thời
- **shops within walking distance** — cửa hàng trong tầm đi bộ
- **affordable housing for the young** — nhà ở giá phải chăng cho người trẻ
- **green spaces and meeting places** — không gian xanh và nơi gặp gỡ
- **planned for every age** — được quy hoạch cho mọi lứa tuổi

#223 Opinion · 281 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the role of community centers in urban areas.

In many neighbourhoods, a building with a hall, a few classrooms and a small sports room serves as a meeting point, and this essay will discuss the role of community centres in urban areas, focusing on social contact and on services for different groups.

To begin with, community centres bring neighbours together. They offer classes, sport, childcare and advice to people of all ages, reduce loneliness and help newcomers to integrate, although they need steady funding and good management. A woman who has just moved to a city, for example, can join a language class or a cooking club and meet people in her neighbourhood within a week. In large cities, where residents often do not know the people next door, these places create a sense of belonging and trust. Festivals, markets and local meetings held there strengthen community identity and give residents a chance to discuss local problems and to organise improvements.

Furthermore, community centres provide services that cities otherwise lack. Children can do homework in a supervised room after school, teenagers can find a safe alternative to the street, and older people can attend lunch clubs, exercise groups and computer lessons. Migrants can get help with forms and language, and unemployed people can use computers and attend job-search workshops. Because activities are cheap or free, they are open to families on low incomes. However, centres need regular funding, qualified staff and volunteers, or they may close or be used by only a few groups. When they are well managed, they lower social isolation and build stronger communities.

In conclusion, community centres play an important role in urban areas by connecting people and providing services, and councils should support them.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a building with a hall, a few classrooms** — toà nhà có hội trường, vài lớp học
- **a meeting point** — điểm gặp gỡ
- **community centres** — trung tâm cộng đồng
- **bring neighbours together** — gắn kết hàng xóm
- **classes, sport, childcare and advice** — lớp học, thể thao, giữ trẻ và tư vấn
- **reduce loneliness** — giảm cô đơn
- **help newcomers to integrate** — giúp người mới đến hoà nhập
- **join a language class or a cooking club** — tham gia lớp ngôn ngữ hoặc câu lạc bộ nấu ăn
- **a sense of belonging and trust** — cảm giác gắn bó và niềm tin
- **Festivals, markets and local meetings** — lễ hội, chợ và các cuộc họp địa phương
- **community identity** — bản sắc cộng đồng
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **supervised room after school** — phòng có người giám sát sau giờ học
- **a safe alternative to the street** — một lựa chọn an toàn thay cho đường phố
- **lunch clubs, exercise groups and computer lessons** — câu lạc bộ ăn trưa, nhóm tập thể dục và lớp tin học
- **help with forms and language** — giúp đỡ về biểu mẫu và ngôn ngữ
- **job-search workshops** — hội thảo tìm việc
- **open to families on low incomes** — dành cho các gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **qualified staff and volunteers** — nhân viên có chuyên môn và tình nguyện viên
- **lower social isolation** — giảm sự cô lập xã hội

#338 Opinion · 285 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how public transport improvements can reduce social inequality.

In many cities, the cost and difficulty of travel decide who can take a job or visit a doctor, and this essay will discuss how public transport improvements can reduce social inequality, focusing on access to opportunity and on cost.

To begin with, better public transport reduces inequality by connecting poorer areas with jobs and services. People without cars are tied to the jobs, schools and clinics within walking distance, so cheap, reliable routes widen their choices and save the cost of owning a vehicle. A resident of a low-income suburb, for example, who can reach the business district in thirty minutes by tram, can apply for a far wider range of jobs than one who depends on a bus that runs twice an hour. Students gain access to better schools and universities, and patients can attend specialist hospitals. Studies show that people with good transport links are more likely to find work and to earn higher incomes.

Furthermore, public transport lowers costs for poor households. Owning a car costs more than many families earn in a month, because of fuel, insurance and repairs, whereas a monthly pass is cheap. Reduced fares for students, the unemployed and the elderly make the system fairer, and integrated tickets avoid paying more for changing buses. Improvements also reach disabled people and women who may feel unsafe on poorly lit routes, if stations and vehicles are accessible and well monitored. However, improvements must reach the poorest districts, which are often served last, otherwise investment may only benefit wealthy areas. When planned fairly, better transport makes opportunity more equal.

In conclusion, public transport improvements can reduce social inequality by widening access to jobs and services and by cutting travel costs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **the cost and difficulty of travel** — chi phí và khó khăn khi đi lại
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **reduce social inequality** — giảm bất bình đẳng xã hội
- **access to opportunity and on cost** — khả năng tiếp cận cơ hội và chi phí
- **connecting poorer areas with jobs and services** — nối các khu nghèo với việc làm và dịch vụ
- **People without cars are tied to** — người không có xe bị ràng buộc vào
- **within walking distance** — trong tầm đi bộ
- **cheap, reliable routes** — tuyến đường rẻ và đáng tin cậy
- **widen their choices** — mở rộng lựa chọn của họ
- **a low-income suburb** — khu ngoại ô thu nhập thấp
- **the business district** — khu trung tâm kinh doanh
- **a far wider range of jobs** — phạm vi việc làm rộng hơn nhiều
- **better schools and universities** — trường học và đại học tốt hơn
- **specialist hospitals** — bệnh viện chuyên khoa
- **good transport links** — kết nối giao thông tốt
- **fuel, insurance and repairs** — nhiên liệu, bảo hiểm và sửa chữa
- **a monthly pass** — vé tháng
- **Reduced fares for students, the unemployed and the elderly** — giá vé giảm cho sinh viên, người thất nghiệp và người cao tuổi
- **integrated tickets** — vé tích hợp
- **poorly lit routes** — tuyến đường thiếu ánh sáng
- **widening access** — mở rộng tiếp cận

Advantages / Disadvantages

#39 Advantages / Disadvantages · 266 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of electric cars outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Sales of electric cars have grown rapidly, and the question is whether their advantages outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, electric cars cut local pollution and running costs. They emit nothing from the exhaust, are quiet and cheap to run. A taxi driver who switches to an electric model, for example, may save a large part of his fuel bill, and residents of a busy street breathe cleaner air and hear less noise. Electric motors also need less maintenance than petrol engines, because they have fewer moving parts. Since transport is a major source of greenhouse gases, the shift to electricity, particularly when it comes from renewable sources, can contribute to climate targets. Many governments also offer tax benefits and free parking for electric vehicles.

On the negative side, electric cars face high prices and charging limits. Purchase prices, scarce chargers, battery production and electricity from coal reduce their benefit. A person who lives in a flat with no private parking, for example, may find it hard to charge a car overnight, and long journeys require planning around charging stations. The mining of materials for batteries causes environmental and social damage, and old batteries must be recycled. Nevertheless, prices are falling, networks of chargers are growing and batteries are improving in range and lifespan. The net gain also increases as electricity grids become cleaner.

In conclusion, electric cars have important advantages for air quality and costs, and I believe that they outweigh the disadvantages, provided that governments invest in charging infrastructure and clean electricity.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Sales of electric cars have grown rapidly** — doanh số xe điện đã tăng nhanh
- **cut local pollution and running costs** — giảm ô nhiễm cục bộ và chi phí vận hành
- **emit nothing from the exhaust** — không thải gì từ ống xả
- **quiet and cheap to run** — êm và rẻ khi vận hành
- **switches to an electric model** — chuyển sang mẫu xe điện
- **save a large part of his fuel bill** — tiết kiệm một phần lớn hoá đơn nhiên liệu
- **breathe cleaner air and hear less noise** — hít không khí sạch hơn và nghe ít tiếng ồn hơn
- **need less maintenance** — cần ít bảo trì hơn
- **fewer moving parts** — ít bộ phận chuyển động hơn
- **greenhouse gases** — khí nhà kính
- **renewable sources** — nguồn tái tạo
- **tax benefits and free parking** — ưu đãi thuế và đỗ xe miễn phí
- **high prices and charging limits** — giá cao và hạn chế về sạc
- **scarce chargers** — trạm sạc khan hiếm
- **battery production and electricity from coal** — sản xuất pin và điện từ than
- **a flat with no private parking** — căn hộ không có chỗ đỗ xe riêng
- **long journeys require planning** — các chuyến đi dài cần lên kế hoạch
- **The mining of materials for batteries** — việc khai thác vật liệu cho pin
- **old batteries must be recycled** — pin cũ phải được tái chế
- **range and lifespan** — quãng đường và tuổi thọ
- **electricity grids become cleaner** — lưới điện trở nên sạch hơn
- **clean electricity** — điện sạch

#177 Advantages / Disadvantages · 274 từ · AI 7.0

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on public housing? Use examples.

Some governments build and manage large numbers of homes for ordinary families, and this essay will discuss the benefits for a country that focuses on public housing, using examples from countries such as Singapore and Austria.

To begin with, public housing gives stability and lowers housing stress. Affordable state homes protect families from rent shocks, reduce homelessness and let workers live near jobs. In Singapore, for example, most residents live in government-built flats which they can buy at reasonable prices, so that home ownership is widespread and families feel secure. In Vienna, the city owns hundreds of thousands of apartments rented at moderate prices, and tenants rarely have to worry about sudden increases. When housing costs are under control, people can spend more on food, education and savings, which supports the whole economy. Governments also have more influence on the quality and location of homes, so that estates can be built close to public transport.

Furthermore, public housing promotes social cohesion. Well-planned estates keep different income groups together, which reduces segregation and the concentration of poverty. In Singapore, rules on ethnic mix in each block help communities to mingle. Stable housing also improves children's education and health, since families do not need to move repeatedly. Employers benefit because workers can live near their jobs and are less likely to be absent. The main disadvantage is the cost to taxpayers and the risk of poor maintenance, but a country that manages the programme well gains stronger communities and a healthier economy.

In conclusion, a country that focuses on public housing gains stability, lower housing stress and mixed communities, and these benefits justify the public investment.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **build and manage large numbers of homes for ordinary families** — xây và quản lý số lượng lớn nhà cho các gia đình bình thường
- **public housing** — nhà ở công
- **stability and lowers housing stress** — sự ổn định và giảm áp lực về nhà ở
- **protect families from rent shocks** — bảo vệ các gia đình khỏi cú sốc giá thuê
- **reduce homelessness** — giảm vô gia cư
- **live near jobs** — sống gần nơi làm việc
- **government-built flats** — căn hộ do chính phủ xây
- **home ownership is widespread** — việc sở hữu nhà phổ biến
- **hundreds of thousands of apartments rented at moderate prices** — hàng trăm nghìn căn hộ cho thuê giá vừa phải
- **sudden increases** — những đợt tăng giá đột ngột
- **more on food, education and savings** — nhiều hơn cho thực phẩm, giáo dục và tiết kiệm
- **the quality and location of homes** — chất lượng và vị trí nhà ở
- **close to public transport** — gần giao thông công cộng
- **promotes social cohesion** — thúc đẩy sự gắn kết xã hội
- **different income groups together** — các nhóm thu nhập khác nhau cùng nhau
- **segregation and the concentration of poverty** — sự phân biệt và tập trung nghèo đói
- **ethnic mix** — sự pha trộn sắc tộc
- **move repeatedly** — chuyển nhà liên tục
- **live near their jobs** — sống gần nơi làm việc
- **poor maintenance** — bảo trì kém
- **a healthier economy** — nền kinh tế khoẻ mạnh hơn

#239 Advantages / Disadvantages · 275 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of living in high-density cities outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

More and more people live in compact cities with tall buildings and few detached houses, and the question is whether the advantages of high-density living outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, high-density cities use land and energy efficiently. Compact cities make public transport and services economical and save countryside. A district where thousands of people live within walking distance of a metro station, for example, supports frequent trains, and residents can reach shops, schools and hospitals without a car. Shorter journeys mean lower emissions, and sharing walls reduces heating costs. Dense cities also offer more jobs and cultural variety, and they leave fields and forests untouched around them. Economies of scale lower the cost of water, power and waste services per person.

On the negative side, crowding, noise, costly housing and lack of green space reduce quality of life. A family in a small flat on the twentieth floor, for example, may have no garden and few places for children to play. Housing is expensive because land is scarce, and crowded buses and streets cause stress. Infections spread more easily in crowded places, and noise and pollution may harm health. Nevertheless, good design can offset many of these drawbacks: parks, tree-lined streets, mixed-use developments, high-quality public transport and sound insulation make dense neighbourhoods more pleasant. Cities such as Singapore and Copenhagen show that high density can go together with a high quality of life.

In conclusion, high-density cities have clear environmental and economic advantages. On balance, I believe that they outweigh the disadvantages, provided that planners protect green space and quality of life.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **compact cities with tall buildings** — thành phố nén với các toà nhà cao tầng
- **high-density living** — sống ở mật độ cao
- **use land and energy efficiently** — sử dụng đất và năng lượng hiệu quả
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **economical** — tiết kiệm chi phí
- **save countryside** — bảo tồn vùng nông thôn
- **within walking distance of a metro station** — trong tầm đi bộ đến ga tàu điện ngầm
- **frequent trains** — tàu chạy thường xuyên
- **without a car** — không cần xe hơi
- **Shorter journeys mean lower emissions** — chuyến đi ngắn hơn nghĩa là khí thải thấp hơn
- **sharing walls reduces heating costs** — chung tường làm giảm chi phí sưởi
- **cultural variety** — sự đa dạng văn hoá
- **Economies of scale** — lợi thế quy mô
- **crowding, noise, costly housing and lack of green space** — đông đúc, ồn ào, nhà ở đắt đỏ và thiếu không gian xanh
- **quality of life** — chất lượng cuộc sống
- **a small flat on the twentieth floor** — căn hộ nhỏ ở tầng hai mươi
- **land is scarce** — đất đai khan hiếm
- **Infections spread more easily** — bệnh nhiễm trùng lây dễ hơn
- **parks, tree-lined streets, mixed-use developments** — công viên, đường có hàng cây, khu phát triển đa chức năng
- **sound insulation** — cách âm
- **green space** — không gian xanh

#268 Advantages / Disadvantages · 289 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of home ownership.

In many countries, owning a home is regarded as a natural goal, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of home ownership before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, owning a home gives security and an asset. Owners avoid rent rises and build wealth as mortgages are repaid. A family that buys a flat in their twenties, for example, may own it outright by retirement, which gives them a place to live and something to leave to their children. Owners cannot be forced to leave at a landlord's wish, and they can decorate, extend and repair their home as they like. Ownership also encourages people to look after their neighbourhood and to take part in local life, because they plan to stay for many years. In many countries, a house is a source of savings that can be used in old age.

On the negative side, home ownership brings debt and reduces mobility. Large loans, repair bills and the difficulty of moving for work are heavy burdens. A worker who has a mortgage on a house in a declining town, for example, may be unable to sell it and accept a better job elsewhere. Interest rates can rise suddenly and put families in trouble, and house prices can fall, leaving owners with debts higher than the value of their home. Maintenance, insurance and taxes add costs that tenants do not pay. Nevertheless, these risks can be reduced if buyers borrow only what they can afford and keep some savings.

In conclusion, home ownership offers security but also financial risk. On balance, I believe that it is worthwhile for people with stable jobs and savings, while renting remains a sensible choice for those who need flexibility.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **owning a home is regarded as a natural goal** — sở hữu nhà được coi là mục tiêu tự nhiên
- **home ownership** — việc sở hữu nhà
- **security and an asset** — sự an toàn và một tài sản
- **avoid rent rises** — tránh việc tăng tiền thuê
- **build wealth as mortgages are repaid** — tích luỹ tài sản khi khoản vay thế chấp được trả
- **buys a flat in their twenties** — mua căn hộ ở độ tuổi hai mươi
- **own it outright by retirement** — sở hữu hoàn toàn khi nghỉ hưu
- **a place to live** — nơi sinh sống
- **leave to their children** — để lại cho con cái
- **forced to leave at a landlord's wish** — bị buộc rời đi theo ý muốn của chủ nhà
- **decorate, extend and repair their home** — trang trí, mở rộng và sửa nhà
- **look after their neighbourhood** — chăm sóc khu phố của mình
- **a source of savings** — nguồn tiết kiệm
- **debt and reduces mobility** — nợ nần và làm giảm tính linh hoạt di chuyển
- **Large loans, repair bills** — khoản vay lớn, hoá đơn sửa chữa
- **a mortgage on a house in a declining town** — khoản thế chấp cho ngôi nhà ở thị trấn đang suy tàn
- **accept a better job elsewhere** — nhận công việc tốt hơn ở nơi khác
- **Interest rates can rise suddenly** — lãi suất có thể tăng đột ngột
- **debts higher than the value of their home** — khoản nợ cao hơn giá trị căn nhà
- **Maintenance, insurance and taxes** — bảo trì, bảo hiểm và thuế
- **borrow only what they can afford** — chỉ vay những gì họ có khả năng trả

#361 Advantages / Disadvantages · 271 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of urban renewal projects outweigh the displacement they cause? Give reasons and examples.

Run-down districts are being cleared and rebuilt in many cities, and the question is whether the advantages of urban renewal projects outweigh the displacement they cause. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, urban renewal improves neighbourhoods. New buildings, services and investment raise safety and property values. A former industrial district that is replaced by modern flats, parks and shops, for example, becomes attractive to businesses and residents, and it provides construction and permanent jobs. Old, unsafe housing without proper sanitation is replaced by healthy homes, and better lighting and design reduce crime. Renewal can also connect neglected areas to the rest of the city through new roads, tram lines and public squares, and it increases the tax revenue that pays for local services.

On the negative side, rising rents and evictions push out low-income residents and destroy community ties. A family that has lived in a district for thirty years, for example, may be unable to afford the new flats and must move to the outskirts, far from friends, schools and work. Small shops and traditional crafts disappear when the buildings are demolished. Some projects benefit developers and wealthy buyers more than the original residents. Nevertheless, the harm can be reduced if governments guarantee fair compensation, provide new homes in the same district, keep a share of the flats at affordable rents and consult local people from the beginning.

In conclusion, urban renewal brings real benefits to neighbourhoods and cities. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the displacement only when residents are protected by compensation and the right to return.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Run-down districts are being cleared and rebuilt** — các khu xuống cấp đang được giải toả và xây lại
- **urban renewal projects** — dự án cải tạo đô thị
- **the displacement they cause** — sự di dời mà chúng gây ra
- **New buildings, services and investment raise safety and property values** — toà nhà mới, dịch vụ và đầu tư nâng cao an toàn và giá trị tài sản
- **a former industrial district** — một khu công nghiệp cũ
- **modern flats, parks and shops** — căn hộ hiện đại, công viên và cửa hàng
- **construction and permanent jobs** — việc làm xây dựng và việc làm lâu dài
- **Old, unsafe housing without proper sanitation** — nhà ở cũ, không an toàn và thiếu vệ sinh đúng mức
- **better lighting and design reduce crime** — ánh sáng và thiết kế tốt hơn giảm tội phạm
- **neglected areas** — các khu bị bỏ rơi
- **public squares** — quảng trường công cộng
- **rising rents and evictions** — tiền thuê tăng và việc đuổi nhà
- **destroy community ties** — phá huỷ mối liên kết cộng đồng
- **lived in a district for thirty years** — sống ở một khu ba mươi năm
- **the outskirts** — vùng ngoại ô
- **Small shops and traditional crafts** — cửa hàng nhỏ và nghề thủ công truyền thống
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **demolished** — bị phá bỏ
- **fair compensation** — bồi thường công bằng
- **new homes** — nhà mới
- **affordable rents** — giá thuê phải chăng
- **consult local people** — tham vấn người dân địa phương
- **the right to return** — quyền được quay lại

#459 Advantages / Disadvantages · 282 từ · AI 7.5

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on affordable housing programs? Use examples.

Several governments have built large numbers of affordable homes, and this essay will discuss the benefits for a country that focuses on affordable housing programmes, using examples such as Finland and Singapore.

To begin with, affordable housing programmes protect families and the economy. Shelter is a basic need, and when homes are within reach of ordinary incomes, households can spend more on food, education and savings. In Finland, for example, a policy known as housing first offers permanent homes to homeless people, and it has reduced homelessness while saving money on emergency services. When workers can afford to live near their jobs, they spend less time commuting, and employers find it easier to recruit nurses, teachers and shop assistants. Stable housing also improves children's school results and family health, because families are not forced to move repeatedly. Affordable housing reduces debt and stress, which in turn supports the productivity of the whole country.

Furthermore, affordable housing programmes promote social cohesion. Mixed estates, in which people of different incomes live together, reduce segregation and the concentration of poverty. Singapore has built flats for most of its population, with rules that mix ethnic groups in each block, and the result has been a high level of home ownership and social peace. Construction itself creates jobs, and well-planned estates near public transport reduce car use. The drawbacks are the cost to taxpayers and the risk that poor design could create run-down areas, but good management and regular maintenance avoid these problems. Countries that invest in affordable housing gain a more stable and fairer society.

In conclusion, a country that focuses on affordable housing programmes benefits through stronger families, a healthier economy and more cohesive communities.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **built large numbers of affordable homes** — xây số lượng lớn nhà ở giá phải chăng
- **affordable housing programmes** — các chương trình nhà ở giá phải chăng
- **protect families and the economy** — bảo vệ các gia đình và nền kinh tế
- **Shelter is a basic need** — chỗ ở là nhu cầu cơ bản
- **within reach of ordinary incomes** — trong tầm với của thu nhập bình thường
- **more on food, education and savings** — nhiều hơn cho thực phẩm, giáo dục và tiết kiệm
- **housing first** — ưu tiên nhà ở trước
- **offers permanent homes to homeless people** — cung cấp nhà ở lâu dài cho người vô gia cư
- **saving money on emergency services** — tiết kiệm tiền cho dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **live near their jobs** — sống gần nơi làm việc
- **recruit nurses, teachers and shop assistants** — tuyển y tá, giáo viên và nhân viên bán hàng
- **children's school results and family health** — kết quả học tập của trẻ và sức khoẻ gia đình
- **move repeatedly** — chuyển nhà liên tục
- **affordable housing** — nhà ở giá phải chăng
- **reduces debt and stress** — giảm nợ và căng thẳng
- **promote social cohesion** — thúc đẩy sự gắn kết xã hội
- **Mixed estates** — khu nhà hỗn hợp
- **segregation and the concentration of poverty** — sự phân biệt và tập trung nghèo đói
- **mix ethnic groups in each block** — trộn các nhóm sắc tộc trong mỗi khối nhà
- **a high level of home ownership and social peace** — tỷ lệ sở hữu nhà cao và hoà bình xã hội
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **run-down areas** — các khu xuống cấp
- **a more stable and fairer society** — xã hội ổn định và công bằng hơn
- **a healthier economy** — nền kinh tế khoẻ mạnh hơn

#497 Advantages / Disadvantages · 272 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of public transport.

Millions of people rely on buses, trains and trams every day, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of public transport before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, public transport is cheap and clean. Shared vehicles cut costs, congestion and emissions. A commuter who takes the metro, for example, avoids fuel, parking charges and traffic jams, and can read or relax on the way to work. One full train can replace hundreds of cars, which lowers air pollution and the number of accidents. Public transport also gives mobility to people who cannot drive, such as the young, the elderly and those with low incomes or disabilities, and it reduces the need for road space. Cities with good systems are also generally quieter and easier to live in.

On the negative side, public transport is less flexible than a car. Fixed routes, crowding, delays and limited late services make it inconvenient. A shift worker who finishes at midnight, for example, may find that the last bus has gone, and a parent with heavy shopping and small children may struggle on a crowded tram. Strikes and breakdowns can disrupt journeys, and in some places, passengers feel unsafe at night. Journeys that need several changes can take much longer than the same trip by car, and rural areas are poorly served. Nevertheless, frequent, safe and clean services overcome most of these problems, as the best systems in Europe and Asia show.

In conclusion, public transport has important advantages for cost, environment and equality. On balance, I believe that these outweigh the disadvantages, provided that governments invest in frequency, safety and coverage.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **rely on buses, trains and trams every day** — phụ thuộc vào xe buýt, tàu hoả và xe điện mỗi ngày
- **advantages and disadvantages of public transport** — ưu điểm và nhược điểm của giao thông công cộng
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **cheap and clean** — rẻ và sạch
- **Shared vehicles cut costs, congestion and emissions** — phương tiện dùng chung giảm chi phí, tắc nghẽn và khí thải
- **takes the metro** — đi tàu điện ngầm
- **fuel, parking charges and traffic jams** — nhiên liệu, phí đỗ xe và tắc đường
- **read or relax on the way to work** — đọc sách hoặc thư giãn trên đường đi làm
- **replace hundreds of cars** — thay thế hàng trăm chiếc xe hơi
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **people who cannot drive** — những người không thể lái xe
- **road space** — không gian đường
- **quieter and easier to live in** — yên tĩnh hơn và dễ sống hơn
- **less flexible than a car** — kém linh hoạt hơn xe hơi
- **Fixed routes, crowding, delays and limited late services** — tuyến cố định, đông đúc, chậm trễ và ít chuyến muộn
- **the last bus has gone** — chuyến xe buýt cuối đã đi
- **heavy shopping and small children** — đồ mua sắm nặng và trẻ nhỏ
- **Strikes and breakdowns** — đình công và sự cố hỏng hóc
- **feel unsafe at night** — cảm thấy không an toàn vào ban đêm
- **several changes** — nhiều lần đổi chuyến
- **rural areas are poorly served** — vùng nông thôn được phục vụ kém
- **frequency, safety and coverage** — tần suất, an toàn và phạm vi phủ sóng

Causes / Solutions

#42 Causes / Solutions · 265 từ · AI 8.0

How can governments reduce traffic congestion in cities? Suggest practical measures.

Drivers in big cities spend days of every year in queues, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to reduce traffic congestion, focusing on charging for road use and on improving alternatives to the car.

To begin with, governments can cut congestion by charging for road use. Fees at peak times discourage unnecessary trips. A city that charges drivers to enter its centre during rush hour, for example, will see fewer cars, and the money collected can be spent on buses and trains. Higher parking prices in central areas and limits on the number of cars that may enter at certain times work in the same way. Other cities restrict private cars on particular days, or reserve lanes for vehicles with several passengers. Such measures have been successful in some European and Asian cities, where traffic has fallen by a fifth.

In addition, authorities must improve alternatives to driving. Reliable buses and trains, safe cycle lanes and flexible working hours give people other options. Frequent services at reasonable prices make public transport the natural choice, and park-and-ride sites at the edge of the city allow drivers to switch to buses. Employers can allow staff to work at home on some days or to start earlier, which spreads demand across the day. Equally important, planners should locate homes, shops and offices close together so that fewer long journeys are needed. Combined measures keep traffic moving and also reduce pollution and accidents.

In conclusion, road charging together with better public transport and flexible work offers the most realistic way to reduce urban congestion.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **spend days of every year in queues** — mất nhiều ngày mỗi năm xếp hàng
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **reduce traffic congestion** — giảm tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **charging for road use** — thu phí sử dụng đường
- **alternatives to the car** — các lựa chọn thay thế xe hơi
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **Fees at peak times discourage unnecessary trips** — phí vào giờ cao điểm làm nản các chuyến đi không cần thiết
- **charges drivers to enter its centre during rush hour** — thu phí tài xế vào trung tâm giờ cao điểm
- **fewer cars** — ít xe hơn
- **spent on buses and trains** — chi cho xe buýt và tàu hoả
- **Higher parking prices** — giá đỗ xe cao hơn
- **restrict private cars on particular days** — hạn chế xe cá nhân vào những ngày nhất định
- **reserve lanes for vehicles with several passengers** — dành làn cho xe có nhiều hành khách
- **traffic has fallen by a fifth** — lưu lượng giao thông giảm một phần năm
- **Reliable buses and trains, safe cycle lanes and flexible working hours** — xe buýt và tàu đáng tin cậy, làn xe đạp an toàn và giờ làm linh hoạt
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **park-and-ride sites** — bãi đỗ và đi tiếp bằng phương tiện công cộng
- **spreads demand across the day** — trải nhu cầu ra suốt ngày
- **locate homes, shops and offices close together** — đặt nhà, cửa hàng và văn phòng gần nhau
- **fewer long journeys** — ít chuyến đi dài hơn
- **keep traffic moving** — giữ cho giao thông lưu thông
- **urban congestion** — tắc nghẽn đô thị

#109 Causes / Solutions · 291 từ · AI 7.5

What are the causes of homelessness? What solutions can be proposed?

In wealthy and poor countries alike, people sleep in doorways and parks, and this essay will discuss the causes of homelessness and suggest solutions, focusing on housing costs and on personal crises.

To begin with, homelessness results from high housing costs and personal crises. Rent increases, job loss, illness, addiction and family breakdown can leave people without shelter. A worker who loses his job, for example, may fall behind with the rent within months and be evicted, while a woman who flees an abusive partner may have nowhere to go. Shortages of cheap homes mean that low-income families spend most of their money on rent and have no savings for emergencies. Mental illness and drug addiction make it harder for people to keep a home, and young people who leave care or who are rejected by their families are particularly at risk. Once homeless, finding work without an address is extremely difficult.

In terms of solutions, governments need to provide housing and support. Affordable homes, mental health care and job training help people to recover. The most effective approach in several countries is housing first: offering a permanent home immediately, then providing counselling and training. A man who is given a flat and a support worker, for example, is much more likely to find work and stay housed. Authorities can also build more social housing, regulate rents, give temporary help to families who fall behind and provide early support to young people leaving care. Charities, businesses and local communities should work with governments. These measures cost money, but they are cheaper than the cost of emergency healthcare, policing and shelters.

In conclusion, homelessness comes from housing costs and personal crises, and it can be reduced by affordable housing combined with support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **sleep in doorways and parks** — ngủ ở cửa ra vào và công viên
- **causes of homelessness** — nguyên nhân của tình trạng vô gia cư
- **high housing costs and personal crises** — chi phí nhà ở cao và khủng hoảng cá nhân
- **Rent increases, job loss, illness, addiction and family breakdown** — tăng tiền thuê, mất việc, bệnh tật, nghiện ngập và gia đình tan vỡ
- **without shelter** — không có chỗ ở
- **fall behind with the rent** — chậm tiền thuê nhà
- **flees an abusive partner** — trốn khỏi người bạn đời bạo hành
- **Shortages of cheap homes** — thiếu hụt nhà giá rẻ
- **low-income families** — gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **no savings for emergencies** — không có tiền tiết kiệm cho trường hợp khẩn cấp
- **Mental illness and drug addiction** — bệnh tâm thần và nghiện ma tuý
- **leave care** — rời cơ sở chăm sóc
- **finding work without an address** — tìm việc mà không có địa chỉ
- **Affordable homes, mental health care and job training** — nhà ở giá phải chăng, chăm sóc sức khoẻ tâm thần và đào tạo nghề
- **housing first** — ưu tiên nhà ở trước
- **a permanent home immediately** — một ngôi nhà ổn định ngay lập tức
- **counselling and training** — tư vấn và đào tạo
- **a support worker** — nhân viên hỗ trợ
- **build more social housing** — xây thêm nhà ở xã hội
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **fall behind** — bị tụt lại phía sau
- **emergency healthcare, policing and shelters** — chăm sóc y tế khẩn cấp, cảnh sát và nơi trú ẩn
- **affordable housing** — nhà ở giá phải chăng

#129 Causes / Solutions · 281 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of traffic accidents? What solutions can be proposed?

Road crashes kill more than a million people worldwide each year, and this essay will discuss the causes of traffic accidents and suggest solutions, focusing on driver behaviour and on road conditions.

To begin with, most accidents come from human behaviour and poor roads. Speeding, drink driving, tiredness and phone use cause crashes, and bad road design and old vehicles increase risk. A driver who sends a message while travelling at fifty kilometres an hour, for example, covers the length of a football pitch without looking at the road. Young men are especially likely to take risks, and long-distance lorry drivers may drive for too many hours without rest. In many developing countries, poor lighting, damaged surfaces, missing signs and mixed traffic of cars, motorbikes and pedestrians make accidents more likely. Vehicles that are badly maintained, with worn tyres or faulty brakes, add to the problem.

In terms of solutions, both enforcement and engineering are needed. Cameras, penalties, education and better roads reduce harm. Speed cameras and breath tests, together with heavy fines and loss of licences, discourage dangerous behaviour. A city that installs cameras on its busiest roads, for example, often sees a clear fall in deaths within a year. Governments should also improve roads with lighting, barriers, crossings and safer junctions, require regular vehicle inspections and promote safety features such as seat belts and airbags. Schools and media campaigns can teach young people about the dangers of drink and speed. Equally important, strong public transport reduces the number of vehicles on the road and so lowers risk.

In conclusion, accidents are caused by human behaviour and weak infrastructure, and they can be reduced through enforcement, education and safer roads.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Road crashes kill more than a million people** — va chạm giao thông giết chết hơn một triệu người
- **causes of traffic accidents** — nguyên nhân tai nạn giao thông
- **Speeding, drink driving, tiredness and phone use** — chạy quá tốc độ, lái xe khi say, mệt mỏi và dùng điện thoại
- **bad road design and old vehicles** — thiết kế đường tồi và xe cũ
- **sends a message while travelling** — nhắn tin trong khi đang di chuyển
- **the length of a football pitch** — chiều dài một sân bóng đá
- **take risks** — liều lĩnh
- **long-distance lorry drivers** — tài xế xe tải đường dài
- **poor lighting, damaged surfaces, missing signs** — ánh sáng kém, mặt đường hư hỏng, thiếu biển báo
- **mixed traffic of cars, motorbikes and pedestrians** — giao thông hỗn hợp xe hơi, xe máy và người đi bộ
- **worn tyres or faulty brakes** — lốp mòn hoặc phanh hỏng
- **Cameras, penalties, education and better roads** — camera, hình phạt, giáo dục và đường tốt hơn
- **reduce harm** — giảm tác hại
- **Speed cameras and breath tests** — camera đo tốc độ và kiểm tra nồng độ cồn
- **heavy fines and loss of licences** — phạt nặng và mất bằng lái
- **barriers, crossings and safer junctions** — rào chắn, vạch qua đường và ngã tư an toàn hơn
- **regular vehicle inspections** — kiểm định phương tiện định kỳ
- **seat belts and airbags** — dây an toàn và túi khí
- **media campaigns** — chiến dịch truyền thông
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng

#182 Causes / Solutions · 292 từ · AI 7.5

How can governments improve road safety for cyclists? Suggest practical measures.

Cycling is cheap, healthy and clean, but many people do not dare to ride in busy cities, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to improve road safety for cyclists, focusing on protected infrastructure and on rules and behaviour.

To begin with, protected lanes and lower speeds are the most effective way to keep cyclists safe. Physical separation from traffic prevents collisions, while lower limits, priority at junctions and driver training reduce risk. A city that builds a lane with kerbs or barriers on a busy road, for example, sees a large fall in injuries among cyclists and an increase in the number who ride. Cycle routes should form a connected network so that riders are not forced to share dangerous junctions or roundabouts with heavy lorries. Speed limits of thirty kilometres an hour in residential streets give drivers more time to react and make crashes less serious. Good lighting and well-maintained surfaces matter as well.

In addition, authorities should improve rules and behaviour. Lights and helmets protect cyclists themselves, and campaigns can persuade riders to use them. Drivers should be taught to look for cyclists, to leave a safe distance when overtaking and to check before opening doors, and these rules should be included in the driving test. Large lorries can be fitted with mirrors and sensors that remove blind spots. Traffic signals can give cyclists a head start at junctions, and police should punish drivers who endanger them. Equally important, safe routes to schools encourage children to cycle from an early age. Safer roads encourage more people to cycle, which in turn benefits health and reduces pollution.

In conclusion, protected lanes, lower speeds and clear rules offer the most realistic way to improve safety for cyclists.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Cycling is cheap, healthy and clean** — đi xe đạp rẻ, tốt cho sức khoẻ và sạch
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **road safety for cyclists** — an toàn đường bộ cho người đi xe đạp
- **protected infrastructure** — hạ tầng được bảo vệ
- **Protected lanes and lower speeds** — làn đường được bảo vệ và tốc độ thấp hơn
- **Physical separation from traffic prevents collisions** — sự tách biệt vật lý khỏi giao thông ngăn ngừa va chạm
- **priority at junctions and driver training** — ưu tiên tại ngã tư và đào tạo tài xế
- **kerbs or barriers** — bờ vỉa hoặc rào chắn
- **a large fall in injuries among cyclists** — sự giảm mạnh thương tích ở người đi xe đạp
- **cycle routes** — đường dành cho xe đạp
- **a connected network** — mạng lưới liên kết
- **roundabouts with heavy lorries** — vòng xuyến có xe tải nặng
- **thirty kilometres an hour in residential streets** — ba mươi km/giờ ở khu dân cư
- **more time to react** — nhiều thời gian hơn để phản ứng
- **Lights and helmets** — đèn và mũ bảo hiểm
- **leave a safe distance when overtaking** — giữ khoảng cách an toàn khi vượt
- **opening doors** — mở cửa xe
- **mirrors and sensors that remove blind spots** — gương và cảm biến loại bỏ điểm mù
- **a head start at junctions** — xuất phát trước tại ngã tư
- **endanger them** — gây nguy hiểm cho họ
- **safe routes to schools** — tuyến đường an toàn đến trường

#249 Causes / Solutions · 297 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of rural depopulation? What solutions can be proposed?

In many countries, villages are losing their young people and are becoming silent, and this essay will discuss the causes of rural depopulation and suggest solutions, focusing on jobs and on services.

To begin with, rural depopulation results from a lack of jobs and services. Young people leave for work and study, farms become less profitable, and schools and clinics close. A young woman who finishes secondary school in a village, for example, must go to a city to attend university, and she may never return because there are few jobs that use her qualifications. Mechanisation has reduced the number of workers needed in agriculture, and small farms struggle against large competitors. As the population falls, shops, buses and banks close, which makes life harder for those who remain and encourages them to leave as well. Poor internet and long distances to hospitals add to the problem, and city life appears more attractive and modern.

In terms of solutions, investment in jobs and services is needed to keep people. Fast internet, local business support and decent transport can make villages viable. A village with good broadband, for example, can attract remote workers and small firms that sell their products online. Governments can offer tax benefits to businesses that locate in rural areas, support tourism and local food products, and move some public offices out of the capital. Schools and clinics should be kept open or replaced by mobile services, and scholarships can encourage graduates to return as doctors and teachers. Improved roads and buses connect villages to nearby towns. Villages that offer livelihoods retain their residents and even attract new ones.

In conclusion, rural depopulation is caused by a lack of work and services, and it can be reduced through investment in connectivity, businesses and public facilities.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **villages are losing their young people** — các ngôi làng đang mất đi người trẻ
- **rural depopulation** — sự suy giảm dân số nông thôn
- **a lack of jobs and services** — thiếu việc làm và dịch vụ
- **leave for work and study** — ra đi để làm việc và học tập
- **farms become less profitable** — nông trại kém lợi nhuận hơn
- **schools and clinics close** — trường học và trạm y tế đóng cửa
- **finishes secondary school in a village** — học xong trung học ở một ngôi làng
- **few jobs that use her qualifications** — ít công việc dùng đến bằng cấp của cô
- **Mechanisation** — cơ giới hoá
- **small farms struggle against large competitors** — nông trại nhỏ chật vật trước đối thủ lớn
- **shops, buses and banks close** — cửa hàng, xe buýt và ngân hàng đóng cửa
- **long distances to hospitals** — khoảng cách xa đến bệnh viện
- **Fast internet, local business support and decent transport** — internet nhanh, hỗ trợ doanh nghiệp địa phương và giao thông tử tế
- **attract remote workers and small firms** — thu hút người làm việc từ xa và công ty nhỏ
- **tax benefits to businesses** — ưu đãi thuế cho doanh nghiệp
- **local food products** — sản phẩm thực phẩm địa phương
- **move some public offices out of the capital** — chuyển một số cơ quan công ra khỏi thủ đô
- **mobile services** — dịch vụ lưu động
- **scholarships** — học bổng
- **retain their residents** — giữ chân cư dân của mình

#269 Causes / Solutions · 281 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of traffic pollution in major cities? What solutions can be proposed?

On many winter days, a grey haze hangs over major cities, and this essay will discuss the causes of traffic pollution in major cities and suggest solutions, focusing on vehicle fleets and on congestion.

To begin with, traffic pollution comes from old, congested and diesel vehicles. Idling in queues and ageing engines release particles and nitrogen oxides. A diesel bus that crawls through a crowded centre, for example, emits far more fumes per kilometre than the same bus moving freely. Cities with weak public transport force people to drive, and private cars are often used for short trips of only a few kilometres. Poor maintenance and the lack of regular emissions tests mean that many vehicles pollute more than the law allows. In addition, trucks that deliver goods to city centres often use cheap diesel, and tyres and brakes create dust that is harmful to lungs.

In terms of solutions, cities must cut car use and clean the fleet. Low-emission zones, electric buses, charges and better public transport reduce pollution. A city that bans the oldest vehicles from its centre and charges the rest according to their emissions, for example, quickly sees cleaner air. Governments can subsidise electric vehicles and chargers, replace diesel buses with electric ones and require regular inspections. Safe cycle lanes and pedestrian zones give people healthy alternatives, while fines and stronger standards punish heavy polluters. Planners should also reduce the need to travel by placing homes, jobs and shops close together. Air quality and health improve, and fewer people suffer from asthma and heart disease.

In conclusion, traffic pollution is caused by old, congested vehicles, and it can be reduced by cleaner transport and less car use.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a grey haze hangs over major cities** — màn sương xám phủ các thành phố lớn
- **traffic pollution in major cities** — ô nhiễm giao thông ở các thành phố lớn
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **old, congested and diesel vehicles** — xe cũ, tắc nghẽn và xe chạy dầu
- **Idling in queues and ageing engines** — nổ máy chờ trong hàng và động cơ cũ
- **particles and nitrogen oxides** — các hạt bụi và nitơ oxit
- **crawls through a crowded centre** — bò chậm qua trung tâm đông đúc
- **fumes per kilometre** — khí thải mỗi km
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **short trips of only a few kilometres** — chuyến đi ngắn chỉ vài km
- **poor maintenance** — bảo trì kém
- **regular emissions tests** — kiểm tra khí thải định kỳ
- **cheap diesel** — dầu diesel rẻ
- **tyres and brakes create dust** — lốp và phanh tạo ra bụi
- **Low-emission zones, electric buses, charges** — vùng khí thải thấp, xe buýt điện, phí
- **bans the oldest vehicles from its centre** — cấm các xe cũ nhất vào trung tâm
- **according to their emissions** — theo lượng khí thải của chúng
- **regular inspections** — thanh tra định kỳ
- **safe cycle lanes** — làn xe đạp an toàn
- **pedestrian zones** — khu vực dành cho người đi bộ
- **punish heavy polluters** — phạt những kẻ gây ô nhiễm nặng
- **homes, jobs and shops close together** — nhà, việc làm và cửa hàng gần nhau
- **asthma and heart disease** — hen suyễn và bệnh tim

#489 Causes / Solutions · 289 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of high renting rates? What solutions can be proposed?

In many big cities, rent takes half of a young person's salary, and this essay will discuss the causes of high renting rates and suggest solutions, focusing on housing supply and on tenant protection.

To begin with, high rents result from too little housing and strong demand. Cities attract workers faster than homes are built, investors buy property to hold, and wages lag behind prices. A young graduate who moves to a capital for work, for example, competes with dozens of other applicants for each small flat, so landlords can ask for higher rents. Strict planning rules, high land prices and slow approval of projects also keep building low. Moreover, some owners keep homes empty or rent them to tourists through online platforms, which reduces the number of homes available for residents. Low interest rates have encouraged investors to buy second homes, and this pushes prices up even further.

In terms of solutions, governments should build more homes and protect tenants. First, new construction and social housing increase supply and give low-income families an alternative to the private market. A city that releases public land for housing and speeds up planning permission, for example, can increase supply within a few years. Second, a tax on empty homes and limits on short-term holiday lets return flats to the long-term market. Third, rent increases can be regulated so that tenants are protected from sudden rises, while housing allowances help those with the lowest incomes. Encouraging people and businesses to move to smaller cities can also reduce pressure on the capital. Taken together, more supply and fair rules stabilise rents.

In conclusion, high rents arise from shortages and speculation, and they can be reduced through more building and fairer rules for tenants.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **rent takes half of a young person's salary** — tiền thuê nhà chiếm một nửa lương của người trẻ
- **high renting rates** — mức giá thuê nhà cao
- **housing supply and on tenant protection** — nguồn cung nhà ở và bảo vệ người thuê
- **too little housing and strong demand** — quá ít nhà ở và nhu cầu mạnh
- **attract workers faster than homes are built** — thu hút lao động nhanh hơn nhà được xây
- **investors buy property to hold** — nhà đầu tư mua bất động sản để giữ
- **wages lag behind prices** — tiền lương chậm hơn so với giá cả
- **competes with dozens of other applicants** — cạnh tranh với hàng chục người nộp đơn khác
- **ask for higher rents** — đòi giá thuê cao hơn
- **Strict planning rules, high land prices** — quy hoạch nghiêm ngặt, giá đất cao
- **keep homes empty** — để nhà trống
- **rent them to tourists** — cho khách du lịch thuê
- **Low interest rates** — lãi suất thấp
- **second homes** — nhà thứ hai
- **low-income families** — gia đình thu nhập thấp
- **releases public land for housing** — giải phóng đất công cho nhà ở
- **speeds up planning permission** — đẩy nhanh việc cấp phép quy hoạch
- **short-term holiday lets** — cho thuê ngắn hạn kỳ nghỉ
- **housing allowances** — trợ cấp nhà ở
- **the lowest incomes** — thu nhập thấp nhất
- **More supply and fair rules stabilise rents** — nguồn cung nhiều hơn và luật công bằng ổn định giá thuê

Discuss both views

#71 Discuss both views · 264 từ · AI 7.0

Is it better to focus government spending on public transport or on roads? Discuss and give your opinion.

Governments cannot build everything at once, and opinions differ on whether public spending on transport should be focused on public transport or on roads. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of public transport argue that it serves more people per unit of space. Trains and buses carry many passengers with less pollution and help those without cars. A single metro line, for example, can move as many commuters as several motorways, and it takes cars off the streets. Cities that invest in public transport suffer less congestion and air pollution, and they offer mobility to the poor, the young and the elderly. Since transport produces a large share of greenhouse gases, shifting passengers to trains and buses also supports climate targets. New roads, in contrast, often attract more traffic and soon become full again.

On the other hand, supporters of roads argue that they remain essential for goods and remote areas. Freight, rural communities and emergency services depend on good roads. A farmer who needs to deliver milk to the market, or an ambulance that has to reach a village, cannot rely on a train. In regions with few people, public transport is expensive and rarely used, whereas well-built roads give everyone access. Buses also need good roads to run on. Maintaining existing roads prevents accidents and costly damage to vehicles.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that spending should depend on local needs, but in most cities public transport should receive priority, while rural areas need continued investment in roads.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **public spending on transport** — chi tiêu công cho giao thông
- **public transport or on roads** — giao thông công cộng hay đường bộ
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **serves more people per unit of space** — phục vụ nhiều người hơn trên mỗi đơn vị diện tích
- **carry many passengers with less pollution** — chở nhiều hành khách với ít ô nhiễm hơn
- **A single metro line** — một tuyến tàu điện ngầm duy nhất
- **move as many commuters as several motorways** — chở số người đi làm bằng nhiều đường cao tốc
- **takes cars off the streets** — đưa xe hơi khỏi đường phố
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **air pollution** — ô nhiễm không khí
- **offer mobility to the poor, the young and the elderly** — đem lại khả năng đi lại cho người nghèo, người trẻ và người già
- **greenhouse gases** — khí nhà kính
- **attract more traffic** — thu hút thêm giao thông
- **remain essential** — vẫn thiết yếu
- **remote areas** — vùng xa xôi
- **Freight, rural communities and emergency services** — vận tải hàng hoá, cộng đồng nông thôn và dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **deliver milk to the market** — giao sữa ra chợ
- **an ambulance that has to reach a village** — xe cứu thương phải đến một ngôi làng
- **expensive and rarely used** — đắt đỏ và ít được dùng
- **Maintaining existing roads** — bảo trì các con đường hiện có
- **costly damage to vehicles** — hư hại tốn kém cho phương tiện
- **local needs** — nhu cầu địa phương
- **receive priority** — được ưu tiên

#78 Discuss both views · 274 từ · AI 8.0

Some people prefer city life while others prefer countryside life. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Every year, many people leave their villages for big cities, while others do the reverse, and opinions differ on whether city life or countryside life is preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of city life argue that it offers opportunity and variety. Cities have jobs, universities and entertainment, and they provide excellent hospitals, shops and public transport. A young engineer, for example, will find many employers and professional contacts in a city, and she can attend concerts, exhibitions and sports events at weekends. Cities also bring together people of different cultures, which broadens the mind and makes life interesting. For people who value convenience, everything from food delivery to medical specialists is close at hand.

On the other hand, supporters of the countryside argue that it offers peace and community. Rural areas are quiet, affordable and close-knit but lack services and employment. A family that moves to a village, for example, may afford a house with a garden for the price of a small city flat, and children can play outdoors safely. Fresh air, open space and contact with nature improve health and reduce stress. Neighbours know and help each other, which builds a strong sense of belonging. However, the disadvantages include long journeys to hospitals and schools, limited choice of jobs and fewer cultural activities. Cities, in contrast, are expensive, noisy and polluted.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the choice depends on stage of life and priorities: city life suits young people who are building careers, while the countryside suits families and retired people who value tranquillity.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **leave their villages for big cities** — rời làng lên thành phố lớn
- **city life or countryside life** — cuộc sống thành thị hay nông thôn
- **opportunity and variety** — cơ hội và sự đa dạng
- **jobs, universities and entertainment** — việc làm, đại học và giải trí
- **excellent hospitals, shops and public transport** — bệnh viện, cửa hàng và giao thông công cộng tuyệt vời
- **professional contacts** — mối quan hệ nghề nghiệp
- **concerts, exhibitions and sports events** — hoà nhạc, triển lãm và sự kiện thể thao
- **people of different cultures** — những người thuộc nhiều nền văn hoá
- **medical specialists** — bác sĩ chuyên khoa
- **close at hand** — ở gần ngay bên
- **peace and community** — sự yên bình và cộng đồng
- **quiet, affordable and close-knit** — yên tĩnh, giá phải chăng và gắn bó
- **lack services and employment** — thiếu dịch vụ và việc làm
- **a house with a garden** — ngôi nhà có vườn
- **play outdoors safely** — chơi ngoài trời một cách an toàn
- **Fresh air, open space and contact with nature** — không khí trong lành, không gian mở và tiếp xúc thiên nhiên
- **reduce stress** — giảm căng thẳng
- **a strong sense of belonging** — cảm giác gắn bó mạnh mẽ
- **Cities, in contrast, are expensive, noisy and polluted** — ngược lại, thành phố đắt đỏ, ồn ào và ô nhiễm
- **stage of life and priorities** — giai đoạn cuộc đời và các ưu tiên

#118 Discuss both views · 282 từ · AI 7.0

Some people prefer living in apartments while others prefer houses. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

In many cities, people choose between a modern flat in a tower and a house with a garden on the outskirts, and opinions differ on which type of home is better. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of apartments argue that they offer convenience and affordability. Flats are usually closer to work, shops and transport and are cheaper and easier to maintain. A young couple who rent a flat near the metro, for example, can walk to the station and avoid the cost of a second car. Many apartment buildings have shared facilities such as gyms, swimming pools and security staff, and the building manager takes care of repairs. For single people and small households, there is no need for a large space that requires cleaning and costly heating.

On the other hand, supporters of houses argue that they provide space and privacy. Houses give gardens, quiet and room for families but cost more and often lie far from the centre. A family with three children, for example, can use a garden for play, keep pets and have a separate room for each child. Residents have more freedom to decorate, extend and repair their home as they like, and they rarely hear noisy neighbours. A house is also likely to be a better long-term investment in many markets. However, owners must pay for maintenance and often depend on a car to reach work and services.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the choice depends on budget and family stage: flats suit young people and those who want city life, whereas houses are better for families who value space.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a modern flat in a tower** — một căn hộ hiện đại trong toà tháp
- **a house with a garden on the outskirts** — ngôi nhà có vườn ở vùng ngoại ô
- **convenience and affordability** — sự tiện lợi và giá cả phải chăng
- **closer to work, shops and transport** — gần nơi làm việc, cửa hàng và giao thông hơn
- **cheaper and easier to maintain** — rẻ hơn và dễ bảo trì hơn
- **rent a flat near the metro** — thuê căn hộ gần tàu điện ngầm
- **avoid the cost of a second car** — tránh chi phí xe hơi thứ hai
- **gyms, swimming pools and security staff** — phòng gym, bể bơi và nhân viên bảo vệ
- **the building manager takes care of repairs** — quản lý toà nhà lo việc sửa chữa
- **costly heating** — chi phí sưởi ấm tốn kém
- **space and privacy** — không gian và sự riêng tư
- **gardens, quiet and room for families** — vườn, sự yên tĩnh và chỗ cho gia đình
- **lie far from the centre** — nằm xa trung tâm
- **a separate room for each child** — phòng riêng cho mỗi đứa trẻ
- **decorate, extend and repair their home** — trang trí, mở rộng và sửa nhà
- **noisy neighbours** — hàng xóm ồn ào
- **a better long-term investment** — khoản đầu tư dài hạn tốt hơn
- **depend on a car** — phụ thuộc vào xe hơi
- **budget and family stage** — ngân sách và giai đoạn của gia đình

#131 Discuss both views · 269 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on roads or on public transport? Discuss and give your opinion.

Transport budgets are limited, and opinions differ on whether the government should concentrate its money on roads or on public transport. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of roads argue that they remain essential for goods and remote areas. Freight, rural communities and emergency services depend on good roads. A lorry driver who delivers vegetables to a city market, for example, needs wide, well-maintained roads, and no train can reach every village. In countries with scattered populations, public transport is costly and often empty, whereas a good road network gives everyone access to jobs, schools and hospitals. Roads are also needed for buses and taxis, and cars give people freedom to travel at any time. Poorly maintained roads cause accidents and damage vehicles, so repair is a wise use of money.

On the other hand, supporters of public transport argue that it serves more people per unit of space. Trains and buses carry many passengers with less pollution and help those without cars. A tram that carries two hundred passengers, for example, replaces dozens of cars and reduces congestion. Building new roads often encourages more traffic, so they fill again within a few years, whereas improved public transport gives people a real alternative. Cheap and frequent services also help the poor, the young and the elderly to reach work and education, and they reduce greenhouse gases.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that spending should depend on local needs: public transport should come first in large cities, while rural regions need roads that are well maintained.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Transport budgets are limited** — ngân sách giao thông có hạn
- **concentrate its money on roads** — tập trung tiền vào đường bộ
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **remain essential** — vẫn thiết yếu
- **remote areas** — vùng xa xôi
- **Freight, rural communities and emergency services** — vận tải hàng hoá, cộng đồng nông thôn và dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **delivers vegetables to a city market** — giao rau đến chợ thành phố
- **wide, well-maintained roads** — đường rộng được bảo trì tốt
- **reach every village** — đến mọi ngôi làng
- **scattered populations** — dân cư phân tán
- **costly and often empty** — đắt đỏ và thường trống
- **jobs, schools and hospitals** — việc làm, trường học và bệnh viện
- **freedom to travel at any time** — tự do đi lại bất cứ lúc nào
- **poorly maintained** — bảo trì kém
- **cause accidents and damage vehicles** — gây tai nạn và làm hư hại xe cộ
- **a wise use of money** — cách dùng tiền khôn ngoan
- **serves more people per unit of space** — phục vụ nhiều người hơn trên mỗi đơn vị diện tích
- **carry many passengers with less pollution** — chở nhiều hành khách với ít ô nhiễm hơn
- **A tram that carries two hundred passengers** — một xe điện chở hai trăm hành khách
- **replaces dozens of cars** — thay thế hàng chục ô tô
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **encourages more traffic** — khuyến khích thêm giao thông
- **fill again within a few years** — đầy trở lại trong vài năm
- **a real alternative** — một lựa chọn thực sự
- **Cheap and frequent services** — dịch vụ rẻ và thường xuyên
- **reduce greenhouse gases** — giảm khí nhà kính
- **local needs** — nhu cầu địa phương
- **public transport should come first in large cities** — giao thông công cộng nên được ưu tiên ở các thành phố lớn

#307 Discuss both views · 286 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer urban life while others prefer rural life. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

The balance between cities and villages is changing in every continent, and opinions differ on whether urban or rural life is better. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of urban life argue that it provides opportunity and services. Cities have jobs, universities and entertainment, and they provide excellent hospitals, shops and public transport. A nurse who lives in a city, for example, can choose among several hospitals, study for a degree in the evening, and reach any part of the city by metro. Cultural life is rich, with theatres, museums and restaurants offering something for every taste. People of different backgrounds meet, which encourages open-mindedness, and anyone with ambition can find a niche. For many young adults, the energy of a city is a major attraction.

On the other hand, supporters of rural life argue that it offers peace, health and community. The countryside is quiet, affordable and close-knit but lacks services and employment. A retired couple in a village, for example, can buy a spacious house with a garden for much less than a small city flat and enjoy clean air and open views. Contact with nature reduces stress, and neighbours generally know and support each other. The pace of life is slower, with less traffic and noise, and children grow up in safer surroundings. On the other hand, long journeys to hospitals and few cultural events can be frustrating, and young people find limited career choices.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that urban life is better for people at the start of their careers, whereas rural life suits families and older people, and modern technology makes both choices more flexible.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **The balance between cities and villages** — cán cân giữa thành phố và làng quê
- **urban or rural life** — cuộc sống đô thị hay nông thôn
- **opportunity and services** — cơ hội và dịch vụ
- **jobs, universities and entertainment** — việc làm, đại học và giải trí
- **excellent hospitals, shops and public transport** — bệnh viện, cửa hàng và giao thông công cộng tuyệt vời
- **choose among several hospitals** — chọn giữa nhiều bệnh viện
- **study for a degree in the evening** — học lấy bằng vào buổi tối
- **reach any part of the city by metro** — đến bất kỳ nơi nào trong thành phố bằng tàu điện ngầm
- **theatres, museums and restaurants** — nhà hát, bảo tàng và nhà hàng
- **something for every taste** — có thứ phù hợp mọi sở thích
- **different backgrounds** — xuất thân khác nhau
- **encourages open-mindedness** — khuyến khích sự cởi mở
- **find a niche** — tìm được chỗ đứng
- **the energy of a city** — nguồn năng lượng của thành phố
- **peace, health and community** — sự yên bình, sức khoẻ và cộng đồng
- **quiet, affordable and close-knit** — yên tĩnh, giá phải chăng và gắn bó
- **a retired couple in a village** — một cặp vợ chồng đã nghỉ hưu ở làng
- **a spacious house with a garden** — ngôi nhà rộng có vườn
- **clean air and open views** — không khí trong lành và tầm nhìn thoáng đãng
- **Contact with nature reduces stress** — tiếp xúc với thiên nhiên làm giảm căng thẳng
- **The pace of life is slower** — nhịp sống chậm hơn
- **safer surroundings** — môi trường an toàn hơn
- **limited career choices** — lựa chọn nghề nghiệp hạn chế

#340 Discuss both views · 282 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer to live in gated communities while others prefer open neighborhoods. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

In some cities, residents live behind walls and security gates, while in others streets and parks are open to everyone, and opinions differ on whether gated communities or open neighbourhoods are preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of gated communities argue that they offer security and amenities. Walls and guards give residents a feeling of safety and shared facilities. A family with young children, for example, may feel more comfortable allowing them to play in a private garden or a swimming pool inside a guarded compound than on a public street. Traffic is limited, noise is reduced and strangers cannot enter freely, so that crime is usually lower. Residents often share the cost of maintenance and services, which keeps the area clean and well managed, and property values may be protected by common rules.

On the other hand, supporters of open neighbourhoods argue that they encourage integration. Gated areas separate social groups, limit public access and weaken contact between neighbours, whereas open areas keep streets lively. A resident of an open street, for example, meets neighbours at the shop, in the park and on the way to school, so that trust develops naturally. Gates may also divert traffic to other roads, block shortcuts and deprive outsiders of parks and paths. Critics add that a sense of safety may not be real, because crime depends more on social conditions than on walls, and that division by income can increase suspicion and inequality.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I prefer open neighbourhoods, since they promote community and equality, though good lighting and sensible policing are needed to make people feel safe.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **live behind walls and security gates** — sống sau tường và cổng an ninh
- **open to everyone** — mở cửa cho mọi người
- **gated communities or open neighbourhoods** — khu dân cư có cổng hay khu phố mở
- **security and amenities** — an ninh và tiện ích
- **Walls and guards** — tường và bảo vệ
- **a feeling of safety and shared facilities** — cảm giác an toàn và cơ sở vật chất dùng chung
- **a private garden or a swimming pool** — khu vườn riêng hoặc bể bơi
- **a guarded compound** — khu có bảo vệ
- **strangers cannot enter freely** — người lạ không thể vào tự do
- **crime is usually lower** — tội phạm thường thấp hơn
- **share the cost of maintenance and services** — chia sẻ chi phí bảo trì và dịch vụ
- **property values may be protected** — giá trị tài sản có thể được bảo vệ
- **common rules** — quy tắc chung
- **encourage integration** — khuyến khích sự hoà nhập
- **Gated areas separate social groups** — khu có cổng chia tách các nhóm xã hội
- **limit public access** — hạn chế sự tiếp cận của công chúng
- **keep streets lively** — giữ cho đường phố sôi động
- **trust develops naturally** — niềm tin phát triển một cách tự nhiên
- **divert traffic** — chuyển hướng giao thông
- **a sense of safety** — cảm giác an toàn
- **social conditions** — điều kiện xã hội
- **suspicion and inequality** — sự nghi ngờ và bất bình đẳng
- **good lighting and sensible policing** — ánh sáng tốt và công tác tuần tra hợp lý

#427 Discuss both views · 283 từ · AI 7.0

Some people believe that home ownership is a sign of success. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

In many societies, buying a house is considered a major life goal, and opinions differ on whether home ownership is a sign of success. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters argue that home ownership reflects achievement. A home shows savings, a steady income and stability. A couple who buy a house after years of work, for example, have shown that they can plan and save, and they gain security and respect in their community. Ownership is also a valuable asset that can be passed on to children, and many people feel proud of having a place that is truly their own. Banks lend only to those with reliable earnings, so owning a property demonstrates financial discipline. In some cultures, family and friends regard a home as proof of responsible adulthood.

On the other hand, critics argue that success has many forms, and that ownership alone is a poor measure. Many successful people rent by choice, because they value flexibility, travel or the freedom to move for work, and they invest their money in businesses or education. A young doctor who rents a flat near the hospital, for example, may be doing very well financially. High prices also prevent talented young workers from buying, so a lack of a home may reflect the market rather than lack of effort. Mortgages can cause stress and limit freedom. Happiness, health, relationships and meaningful work matter just as much as property.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that owning a home can be a sign of success in some cases, but it is not the only or the best measure of a good life.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **buying a house is considered a major life goal** — mua nhà được xem là mục tiêu lớn của cuộc đời
- **home ownership is a sign of success** — sở hữu nhà là dấu hiệu thành công
- **home ownership** — việc sở hữu nhà
- **reflects achievement** — phản ánh thành tựu
- **savings, a steady income and stability** — tiền tiết kiệm, thu nhập ổn định và sự ổn định
- **buy a house after years of work** — mua nhà sau nhiều năm làm việc
- **plan and save** — lập kế hoạch và tiết kiệm
- **security and respect in their community** — sự an toàn và sự tôn trọng trong cộng đồng
- **a valuable asset that can be passed on to children** — một tài sản có giá trị có thể truyền lại cho con
- **a place that is truly their own** — một nơi thực sự thuộc về họ
- **reliable earnings** — thu nhập đáng tin cậy
- **financial discipline** — kỷ luật tài chính
- **responsible adulthood** — sự trưởng thành có trách nhiệm
- **success has many forms** — thành công có nhiều dạng
- **rent by choice** — thuê nhà theo lựa chọn
- **the freedom to move for work** — sự tự do chuyển chỗ để làm việc
- **a young doctor who rents a flat near the hospital** — một bác sĩ trẻ thuê căn hộ gần bệnh viện
- **High prices also prevent talented young workers from buying** — giá cao cũng ngăn những người lao động trẻ tài năng mua nhà
- **lack of effort** — thiếu nỗ lực
- **Happiness, health, relationships and meaningful work** — hạnh phúc, sức khoẻ, các mối quan hệ và công việc ý nghĩa
- **the best measure of a good life** — thước đo tốt nhất của cuộc sống tốt đẹp

#447 Discuss both views · 288 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that public parks should be open 24 hours. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some residents would like to jog at dawn or walk late at night, while others worry about safety, and opinions differ on whether public parks should be open twenty-four hours a day. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of full-time opening argue that it gives flexibility. Shift workers, joggers and visitors could use green space at any hour. A nurse who finishes work at midnight, for example, could walk through the park to unwind, and early risers could exercise before the heat of the day. Parks that never close are accessible to people who have no garden, which is important for those who live in small flats. Open spaces can also be used for night-time events, stargazing and festivals, and constant use by many people can make an area feel lively and safe. In some warm countries, evenings are the most comfortable time to be outdoors.

On the other hand, opponents argue that darkness invites problems and costs. Vandalism, noise and crime are more likely at night, and parks need extra lighting and patrols if they stay open. A resident whose home overlooks a park, for example, may be disturbed by groups that gather late and play loud music. Wildlife and plants also need quiet hours, and gates allow staff to clean and repair. Closing at night saves the cost of security staff and reduces the risk of accidents. A sensible compromise is to open the parks for longer hours, with lighting and patrols in the busiest areas, and to keep quiet or sensitive areas closed overnight.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that limited night opening in safe, well-lit parks is the best solution.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **jog at dawn or walk late at night** — chạy bộ lúc bình minh hoặc đi dạo khuya
- **public parks should be open twenty-four hours a day** — công viên công cộng nên mở cửa hai mươi bốn giờ mỗi ngày
- **gives flexibility** — mang lại sự linh hoạt
- **Shift workers, joggers and visitors** — người làm ca, người chạy bộ và du khách
- **green space** — không gian xanh
- **at any hour** — vào bất kỳ giờ nào
- **finishes work at midnight** — tan ca lúc nửa đêm
- **walk through the park to unwind** — đi bộ qua công viên để thư giãn
- **early risers** — người dậy sớm
- **people who have no garden** — những người không có vườn
- **night-time events, stargazing and festivals** — sự kiện ban đêm, ngắm sao và lễ hội
- **feel lively and safe** — cảm thấy sôi động và an toàn
- **darkness invites problems and costs** — bóng tối kéo theo vấn đề và chi phí
- **Vandalism, noise and crime** — phá hoại, tiếng ồn và tội phạm
- **extra lighting and patrols** — chiếu sáng và tuần tra bổ sung
- **overlooks a park** — nhìn ra công viên
- **play loud music** — bật nhạc lớn
- **Wildlife and plants also need quiet hours** — động thực vật cũng cần giờ yên tĩnh
- **clean and repair** — dọn dẹp và sửa chữa
- **a sensible compromise** — sự thoả hiệp hợp lý
- **well-lit parks** — công viên được chiếu sáng tốt

#460 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 8.0

Some people prefer to commute by bicycle while others prefer motor vehicles. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Every morning, millions of commuters must choose between riding a bicycle and driving or riding a motorised vehicle, and opinions differ on which is preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of cycling argue that it is cheap, healthy and clean. Cyclists keep fit and avoid traffic jams in compact cities. A worker who cycles ten minutes along a protected lane, for example, arrives refreshed and does not need to search for parking, while a driver may spend half an hour in a queue. Bicycles cost little to buy and nothing to fuel, and they produce no pollution or noise. Regular exercise reduces the risk of heart disease and improves mood, which also lowers health costs for society. In cities that offer good cycle lanes, such as Amsterdam, a large proportion of residents ride every day.

On the other hand, supporters of motor vehicles argue that they offer speed and comfort over longer distances. Cars and motorbikes are comfortable but costly and polluting, and weather, danger and distance limit cyclists. A person who lives thirty kilometres from the office, for example, cannot realistically cycle every day, and rain, heat or snow make riding unpleasant. Motor vehicles can carry luggage, children and tools, and they offer privacy and protection. In cities with poor cycling infrastructure, riders face real danger from traffic. However, congestion, parking costs and pollution reduce the advantages of cars.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that bicycles are the better choice for short urban journeys when safe lanes are provided, whereas motor vehicles remain necessary for long distances and heavy loads.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **riding a bicycle and driving or riding a motorised vehicle** — đi xe đạp và lái hay đi xe có động cơ
- **cheap, healthy and clean** — rẻ, tốt cho sức khoẻ và sạch
- **keep fit and avoid traffic jams** — giữ dáng và tránh tắc đường
- **a protected lane** — làn đường được bảo vệ
- **arrives refreshed** — đến nơi trong trạng thái sảng khoái
- **search for parking** — tìm chỗ đỗ xe
- **half an hour in a queue** — nửa giờ xếp hàng
- **nothing to fuel** — không tốn tiền nhiên liệu
- **no pollution or noise** — không ô nhiễm hay tiếng ồn
- **heart disease and improves mood** — bệnh tim và cải thiện tâm trạng
- **good cycle lanes** — làn xe đạp tốt
- **speed and comfort over longer distances** — tốc độ và sự thoải mái ở quãng đường dài hơn
- **comfortable but costly and polluting** — thoải mái nhưng đắt đỏ và gây ô nhiễm
- **weather, danger and distance** — thời tiết, nguy hiểm và khoảng cách
- **thirty kilometres from the office** — cách văn phòng ba mươi km
- **rain, heat or snow** — mưa, nóng hoặc tuyết
- **carry luggage, children and tools** — chở hành lý, trẻ em và dụng cụ
- **poor cycling infrastructure** — hạ tầng xe đạp kém
- **congestion, parking costs and pollution** — tắc nghẽn, chi phí đỗ xe và ô nhiễm

#494 Discuss both views · 293 từ · AI 7.0

Some people think that housing is a private matter, while others believe it is a public concern. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some people regard where and how they live as a purely personal decision, while others argue that housing affects everyone, and opinions differ on whether housing is a private matter or a public concern. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of the private view argue that housing is a personal choice made in a market. Individuals decide where and how to live according to their income, tastes and family needs. A couple who choose a small flat in the centre in order to save time, or a family who prefer a house with a garden, for example, are making decisions that suit their own lives. Competition between builders and landlords provides variety and keeps quality up, and when the state interferes too much, rules and taxes can discourage investment and make homes more expensive. People also take better care of property which they have chosen and paid for themselves.

On the other hand, supporters of the public view argue that everyone needs shelter, and the effects are shared. Shortages, homelessness and poor conditions affect health, education and public budgets. A child who grows up in a damp, overcrowded flat, for example, may fall ill and perform badly at school, and these costs fall on society in the end. Governments must therefore set standards for safety and size, support families who cannot afford a home and plan land use so that cities function. Private markets alone have often failed to provide for low-income households.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that housing is both a private choice and a public responsibility: individuals should decide how to live within their means, while governments must ensure that basic shelter is available to all.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a purely personal decision** — một quyết định hoàn toàn cá nhân
- **housing is a private matter or a public concern** — nhà ở là việc riêng hay mối quan tâm công
- **a personal choice made in a market** — lựa chọn cá nhân trong thị trường
- **according to their income, tastes and family needs** — theo thu nhập, sở thích và nhu cầu gia đình
- **a small flat in the centre** — căn hộ nhỏ ở trung tâm
- **save time** — tiết kiệm thời gian
- **a house with a garden** — ngôi nhà có vườn
- **suit their own lives** — phù hợp với cuộc sống riêng của họ
- **Competition between builders and landlords** — sự cạnh tranh giữa nhà thầu và chủ nhà
- **keeps quality up** — giữ chất lượng cao
- **discourage investment** — làm nản đầu tư
- **take better care of property** — chăm sóc tài sản tốt hơn
- **everyone needs shelter** — ai cũng cần nơi trú ngụ
- **Shortages, homelessness and poor conditions** — thiếu hụt, vô gia cư và điều kiện kém
- **health, education and public budgets** — sức khoẻ, giáo dục và ngân sách công
- **a damp, overcrowded flat** — căn hộ ẩm ướt và quá đông
- **these costs fall on society** — những chi phí này đổ lên xã hội
- **set standards for safety and size** — đặt tiêu chuẩn về an toàn và diện tích
- **plan land use** — quy hoạch sử dụng đất
- **Private markets alone have often failed** — chỉ riêng thị trường tư nhân thường đã thất bại
- **basic shelter** — nơi ở cơ bản